

A woman with long dark hair is lying on her back on a beach of smooth, light-colored pebbles. Her eyes are closed, and her arms are raised above her head. She is wearing a dark bikini top and a silver bracelet on her right wrist. The text 'TWO DAYS IN MALTA' is overlaid in large white letters across the center of the image.

TWO DAYS IN MALTA

KT MORRISON



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Contents

[About the Author](#)

[More Licorice Books](#)

[1](#)

[Chapter 1](#)

[Chapter 2](#)

[Chapter 3](#)

[Chapter 4](#)

[2](#)

[Chapter 5](#)

[Chapter 6](#)

[Chapter 7](#)

[3](#)

[Chapter 8](#)

[Chapter 9](#)

[Chapter 10](#)

[4](#)

[Chapter 11](#)

[Chapter 12](#)

[Chapter 13](#)

5

Chapter 14

Chapter 15

Chapter 16

6

Chapter 17

Chapter 18

Chapter 19

Chapter 20

7

[Chapter 21](#)

[Chapter 22](#)

[Chapter 23](#)

[Chapter 24](#)

[8](#)

[Chapter 25](#)

[Chapter 26](#)

[Chapter 27](#)

[Chapter 28](#)

[Chapter 29](#)

[Chapter 30](#)

[Chapter 31](#)

[Chapter 32](#)

[9](#)

[Chapter 33](#)

[Chapter 34](#)

[Chapter 35](#)

[Chapter 36](#)

[Chapter 37](#)

[10](#)

[Chapter 38](#)

[Chapter 39](#)

[Chapter 40](#)

[Chapter 41](#)

[Chapter 42](#)

[11](#)

[Chapter 43](#)

[Chapter 44](#)

[Chapter 45](#)

[12](#)

[Chapter 46](#)

[Chapter 47](#)

[Chapter 48](#)

[13](#)

[Chapter 49](#)

[Chapter 50](#)

[Chapter 51](#)

[Chapter 52](#)

[14](#)

[Chapter 53](#)

[Chapter 54](#)

[Chapter 55](#)

[Afterword](#)

About the Author

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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[Cherry Blossoms](#)

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[Happy Endings](#)

NOVELS

[Going A Little Too Far](#)

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All characters are over the age of twenty-one.

TWO DAYS IN MALTA

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ROWAN

Paisley was concerned with her tan again, checking the brownness of her arms from behind her vintage Goldsmith sunglasses, the same style Audrey Hepburn wore. They were sitting together in the sun on a street-side patio café, tucked in the secret back streets running the heart of Valetta, midway on the mediievally narrow Triq San Gwann, one side in blue shade, their side in hot Malta sunshine.

“Ten bucks he doesn’t show, Rowan,” Paisley said, stretching her long arms out now and rotating loose fists.

“He’ll show.”

“I just don’t want you to get your hopes up,” she said and patted his hand. And it was true: his best friend in the world (at least for a four-year window of time during boarding school), Grady Fletcher, was perpetually unreliable. Not out of some lack of care, or purposeful disrespect, it was just the way it was for Grady, forever untroubled.

“My hopes aren’t up. Believe me.” But there in his voice for his girlfriend to hear was a certain disappointment already weighing him down.

Paisley detected it and tried to be more positive. “Give him a call.”

“We spoke yesterday. He said he’d be coming in on the one o’clock ferry. And he doesn’t keep that stupid phone on.”

Paisley contradicted herself for his sake. “He’ll be here.” She patted his hand again. Then to herself, cursing Grady Fletcher: “A flip-phone of all things.”

“That’s Grady,” he lamented. His boarding school roomie had abandoned his trusty smartphone this summer, bringing along only an old flip-phone he rarely even kept turned on.

Paisley rose now, stood table-side straightening the pleats in the long skirt of her white linen summer dress. There was a split in the skirt that ran almost to mid-thigh, and her bony knee jutted out toward him. He batted it with his own knee. She pivoted then, and sat in his lap, hooked an arm around his neck and they kissed. It felt good to have her in his lap. It had been an amazing summer together so far, and it’d only just begun. He looped arms around her waist. When the kiss broke, she cupped his cheeks. “Time for one more coffee?”

“How about another one of those pistachio biscotti?”

She thought about it, mouth squished aside. “How much money do you have?”

“I think I might have enough. Why don’t you check in my pocket?”

“You want me to put my hand in your pocket?”

“Do you want any money?”

Paisley laughed. “I’m not doing that in public, you pervert,” she said, lightly clapping her warm palms on his cheeks and thumbing the sides of his nose. They kissed again.

“Hold on,” he said, shoving a hand into his pocket, bracing Paisley’s waist with the other. “This would be a lot easier if you would carry some money.”

“This dress doesn’t have any pockets,” she said (though it did, Paisley just didn’t like them weighed down).

“There,” he said, holding out a few Euro coins in his palm. “Biscotto, the pistachio, and two Turkish coffees.”

She gathered the coins in her own hand, looked at him seriously. “We have time for coffees, Rowan, we can split a biscotto, then it’ll be ten-to-one.

We'll go down to the Terminal . . .”

“And Grady will be there,” he said.

PAISLEY

For Rowan's sake, Grady better be there. That aloof asshole. If he let down his best friend, Rowan, one more time . . . well, it could be the end of their friendship. But worse than that, it would hurt her Rowan.

First thing she thought when learning their paths would intersect on her and Rowan's backpacking-across-Europe summer, was that they would arrange to meet Grady and it would fall through. And then she would have a mopey divot in her otherwise fun summer with the young man she was absolutely head over heels in love with.

"Two Turkish coffees," she said, "extra cream, okay, please? And one of those," pointing to the glass display case where the biscotti were arranged on paper doilies over brass plates. "The pistachio."

The server got her order together, and she leaned an elbow on the counter, looking back out to the sunny street-side where Rowan sat in deep contemplation. Grady had been traveling west to east across the Mediterranean coast this summer, going out with two friends from Yale. Rowan was invited—hell, both she and Rowan were invited (they were Europe-bound together already)—but she and Rowan decided they would do it as a couple instead of tagging along in a five-way with a bunch of guys. They figured sometime over the summer they would try to cross paths, but two days ago Rowan heard from Grady by phone call that Grady's travel partners had parted ways, but he was still continuing solo—something he said he preferred, anyway. She and Rowan'd been in Sicily, and Grady was somewhere in northern Italy, near Genoa. They agreed to meet in her and Rowan's next destination: Malta. And Grady better well show up.

The server, smiling: “Your order, here . . .”

She turned, paid the man, took the tray out to the patio. They ate quickly, sipped their coffee quickly, talking about other things than Grady. Happier things. If Grady showed up, all would be well. Grady was never not a good time, it wasn't that at all, it was his dependability that was of concern. That, and that Rowan relied on him so much at The Brinkley School where they'd boarded together in Manhattan, now they'd split up and gone to separate universities Rowan sometimes seemed lost at sea. Despite her boyfriend's amazing winning personality, friendliness, and inherent charm, he didn't easily divulge a full friendship. It was reserved for a select few. She loved being in his graces. They'd been dating now for five years. Through her last two years of high school at the Iris Duncan Academy, she would travel two weekends a month from Hartford into Manhattan to spend a Saturday afternoon with him. Never an overnight, because her mom forbade it, making sure her daughter checked in from the hotel she'd booked, working in conjunction with Rowan's mom. But she was alone in Manhattan with a young man she loved, and she didn't need to spend an overnight with him in order to do the things they wanted to do. Now they were at university together, saw each other all the time, and it was Grady missing from Rowan's life.

They gathered up their things when they were done, brought the plates and cups on the tray into the café, then strode southward to the Upper Barrakka Gardens, then west on the Xatt Lascaris and when she lamented tired feet, Rowan got her up on his back and gave her a piggyback ride, her legs hooked around his waist until they emerged on the Triq l-Għassara ta' l-Gheneb at the Grand Harbor, a bright white ferry coming into port at the Sea Passenger Terminal, and Grady Fletcher better be on board.

GRADY

The best sight for his travel-tired eyes: two familiar faces in the sea of awaiting Maltese swarmed at the navy railing barrier running the port's landing point at the Sea Passenger Terminal.

Two whole days with his best friend who he missed so bad, but kept distance for his friend's sake. And lucky Rowan—so blessed to have a girl like Paisley at his side.

It was Paisley that saw him first, her noticeably tight expression scanning the ferry passengers, eyes hidden behind an enormous pair of tortoiseshell sunglasses, her eyebrows popping right up, smiling with teeth, then waving a long tanned arm above the crowd and elbowing Rowan who jumped, looked at her, then looked where his girlfriend was looking.

And his own heart thudded in his chest to see Rowan's look of relief and happiness wash away the worry in his perpetually concerned friend. No wave from Rowan, only a wide and happy smile and a slow head nod. He offered up his two friends a casual salute and stood patiently at the ferry's railing, waiting for the boat to dock.

Almost fifteen minutes to disembark and pass through the terminal's administration showing his ID, but then he was out and into the sunshine, finding his friends waiting for him apart from the throng, standing on the other side of a harbor-front road that passed under a towering fortress wall in crumbling sunbaked limestone. Rowan had his arms crossed, looking fit, watching him cross the road. They used to wrestle together in the Academy, Rowan a weight class below, but neither of them wrestled in college—Rowan still kept in great shape, not holding quite as much muscle as he did

when he was eighteen and they would eat themselves sick trying to get bulk. And Paisley next to him, in full head-to-toe view now, her beauty hitching his breath. Tall and lean, honey-caramel hair that hung in thick sheets down to her waist; he'd never seen her so tanned. She wore a white cotton dress with a high split in the skirt that showed the tan went up her long thighs; white canvas sneakers, a skinny leather belt and those big sunglasses showed a mature elegance you hardly saw in the college girls he knew.

It'd been a long time on the ferry from Sicily, and before that a hassle of a train ride south to the point of the boot. The whole while wondering if he should meet them or not, knowing he'd let down Rowan, knowing his past with Paisley . . . but now a dozen feet apart his heart swelled in anticipation of getting his arms around them and embracing them. He'd never wanted to hug and be hugged bigger than this before.

He tossed his bag down to slide on the sidewalk, the distance closed, and put out his arms saying, "Holy fuck, guys, am I happy to see you two . . ."

PAISLEY

Grady was looking good—it'd been over thirteen months since she'd last seen him. Grady was taller than Rowan by an inch or two and took up more space. Both of them were muscular, but Grady filled out his T-shirt; his large chest clearly defined under the gray cotton, arms stretching the sleeves. And she couldn't help giggling seeing these two big guys practically colliding together, her heart swelling knowing how happy Rowan must be. They embraced hard, beat on each other's backs loud enough to make hollow thuds, growling and laughing, saying dude to each other.

Rowan let him go, saying, "Man, so good to see you. So glad you're here."

Like that, any bad blood (or hurt blood) completely washed away and they were just friends again. Now Grady's attention turned her way—her first real boyfriend looking her up and down, cocky smile to one side. He was a handsome rogue who took a lot of hearts. When she wasn't dating Grady, her friends all drooled over him. Six-two, high cheekbones, soulful blue-gray eyes, and pouting lips above a wide dimpled chin; it was impossible not to fall for his inherent charm. And she could feel it now. A residual bothersome feeling over his inability to support Rowan when Rowan's dad went through surgery in the fall being hosed away by his twinkling eyes, cocked head and pursed, expectant lips. Waiting to see how mad Paisley was at him, smile quivering, trying his best to convince her everything was okay. And, fuck, it was—Grady meant no harm.

He sensed he'd disarmed her, said, "Paisley, god, look at you—I can't tell you how great it is to see friendly faces."

She surrendered, put out her arms saying, “It is, Grady, I’m so happy you made it . . .”

Grady embraced her, holding her against him and gently squeezing, a grumbling sound in his chest that told her he wasn’t kidding, he really was looking for companionship right now. She went loose so he could hold her, patted her hands on his broad back and eyed Rowan whose eyes practically glowed with happiness that she’d let it go and was ready to receive Grady and let go her simmering animosity.

She shook her head, and Rowan smiled. She reached out to cup his cheek and thumbed his lower lip, and he held her wrist, looking in her eyes and thanking her in his silent Rowan way.

ROWAN

After meeting Grady at the Terminal, they all walked back through Valetta, talking the whole way and catching up. One great thing about Grady was his unflappable nature. Grady didn't come with heaviness or bad feeling, even if he'd let their friendship down this last year. Whatever it was about him, he still seemed blameless. Even though there should be a little bad blood, Grady could disarm you with his disregard for his (or more importantly sometimes your own) failings and fuck-ups, and he proceeded like bygones were bygones. Grady lived in the moment and it was hard to contend with things you might be mad at him for when he came at you with open arms and honest affection. At heart that was what true friendship was about, and Grady proved it with unfailing acceptance.

Now they were walking together, Paisley in between them, negotiating the maze-like neighborhood of close timeworn buildings north of the harbor, using the street until cars came then crowding onto the uneven sidewalk. Grady told them of his trip so far, stopping to marvel at the scenery, taking in the uniqueness of Valetta. Byzantine lanterns hung suspended on chains that crossed above the streets, stacks of narrow balconies looked down from above, some in wrought iron, others boxed in, some draped with laundry to dry in the sun (on the streets that could get it).

Paisley walked with hands in her dress pockets, face turned up to Grady walking with his drab olive canvas bag over his shoulder saying, "No, so Ryan sees this group text with Jared and a bunch of other guys from our dorm, but he's not in the chat—"

Paisley loved gossip and wanted the scene right in her head. "But this is before you guys got on the plane?"

“Yeah, like two days before we’re all supposed to head out. Like, our dorm rooms are all about packing—we got our bags, we got our gear spread out all over our beds . . . And in this chat that Ryan’s not in, some other dudes were talking shit about him—”

Paisley again: “And Ryan is the one who’s high strung . . .”

Grady shifted the weight of his bag on his shoulder. “So high strung, Paisley. Like he can’t function away from home; any kind of new challenge and he’s texting his mom back home. And that’s basically what was in the group chat, kind of making fun of him because he’s a momma’s boy.”

“That’s mean. Were you in the chat?”

Grady said, “Nah, I already got rid of my phone at this point. And precisely because of dumb shit like this . . .”

Paisley loved this story, going on: “And Ryan gets on the plane, anyway?”

“Yeah. Jared wasn’t joining in talking shit about him in the chat, so basically Ryan was mad because Jared didn’t defend him.”

“So it seemed tenable,” Paisley said, knowing all the friend angles, “that the Europe trip would go on.”

“It did,” Grady laughed, “but Ryan just wouldn’t let it go even when we get to Europe, like shooting off snide comments all the time and then Jared just had it. They had this big ass blowout in Barcelona, right out front of the Montjuïc Castle.”

Paisley laughed like she enjoyed hearing how dumb guys are. “What kind of blowout?”

“Oh Paisley,” Grady lamented, laughing to himself and palming his forehead. “So, so embarrassing. I’m standing with them and it turns to yelling. Like yelling profanity, like You fucking piece of shit . . .” Both he and Paisley were laughing now, Grady continuing, “And I’m standing there,

trying to cool them down but nodding to all these freaked out people and thinking Hi, yes, you guessed it, we're tourists."

"So aggro," Paisley laughed, "couldn't wait till they get back to the room . . ."

"Right? But it gets beyond saying bad things and they actually put hands on each other and now I'm thinking I'm going to find out what it's like in a Spanish prison."

He said, "So what'd you do?"

"I grabbed Ryan—"

Paisley said, "The momma's boy."

"Right, but he's the aggressor, so I grab him in a choke and like Jared just throws his hands up and walks away."

"Did they go home?"

"No. They wanted to split up because they weren't going to trek with each other. Ryan said he was going to stay in Barcelona for the summer and Jared has family in Germany so he said he'd go up there. He invited me, but . . ."

"You came to see Europe."

"Yup, so that's what I'm doing. Solo. And to be honest, it's way better than going with those guys, or anyone really. It's all me all the time, and I do whatever I want, whenever."

GRADY

Rowan and Paisley'd rented a cute little Airbnb love-nest down a super-narrow street in a five-hundred-year-old apartment with an iron rail balcony and a huge emerald-painted metal door. It was bright on the inside with some modern amenities, but the walls were almost all rock, and the spaces kind of cramped. It was an open bedroom and living room, one bed, no walls separating the kitchen, only the bathroom.

They'd stopped at their pad only for fifteen minutes to use the bathroom and so he could dump off his bag. Then they were out walking again, the three of them together going to the waterfront, over to the Upper Barrakka Gardens because he wanted to look across the harbor to see Fort St. Angelo, this huge seaside medieval castle once bastioned by the Knights Hospitaller, then stopping for dinner at a restaurant that looked like an adobe but was painted with all these bright-colored cartoon cats with their tails up so you could see their buttholes. They sat for an hour reminiscing about boarding school and missing Manhattan while the night went blue and they watched the moon rise over Fort Manoel on the other side of the Marsamxett Harbor, eating pasta and bread and splitting two bottles of cheap but decent red wine.

Then they hung out with some Canadians outside a hookah place down the road and the Canadians said there was an EDM night at this church out in the west part of the city and that's where they were now, at a huge complex with two different venues, an outdoor festival with a thousand people dancing, then another separate one inside this old medieval church, some special guest DJ from Spain. The DJ was up on an altar and the organizers'd put neon tubing all along the arches that soared the vaulted ceiling twenty feet over their head. Tiger stripes in blue and orange pulsed

and swept the stone walls, and the music pounded. The church was packed, and they all went up and down, putting fists in the air. He lost track of Paisley and Rowan and ended up hanging out with three girls from the University of Malta who spoke great English, then he and the girls found Rowan and Paisley and they went outside to the outdoor festival for some fresh air. Different DJ out there, some French guy, and they bought some Red Bulls and vodka and one of the Maltese girls with black hair and sexy black eyes had molly and they all took some.

By the time the show reached its crescendo, they were all out of it, especially Rowan, having way too good a time, dancing with his shirt off, Paisley touching him all over; they released big red confetti at the end, shooting out of cannons during the light show, and the confetti fluttered through the smoke, sticking on everyone, all over Rowan, red paper wafers the size of toilet paper squares.

They lost the Maltese girls somewhere, and they were all heading back into the church because they still had tickets for that smaller show, but Rowan needed water. He left them alone but in sight, going off in just his shorts and standing in line with some girls who tried dancing with him in the spillover music coming from the cathedral. And Rowan gave them a show, the girls dancing on either side of him, one of them putting her hands on his sweaty body.

He side-eyed Paisley, but she didn't look jealous, only watched her boyfriend and smiling. When she caught him watching her, they both broke out laughing.

Paisley's skin shone with sweat, her gleaming tan an incredible rich color on her perfect skin, her eyes bright and expressive, her perfect smile wide and open showing her straight white teeth, her lips a natural blushed color, Paisley so beautiful she didn't need makeup, any guy looking at her would think she was stunning even with the wet gleam of sweat and her heavy hair hanging limp around her face.

She danced in place, watching him, a hesitant smile on her face like she was considering something.

He was reluctant to dance with her because she was Rowan's girl, but he moved around her, smirking. He asked her what she was thinking.

She pushed her pouted lips to one side, giving him a funny look. She said, "You're just lucky I'm still not mad at you . . ."

PAISLEY

Grady circled her while she danced, her giving him a sly look, feeling like she had genuinely let it go and wanting him to know—just in case he actually cared or had ever considered how his actions might affect others. Then he gave her a sheepish scolded boy face, then averted his eyes.

And now she felt guilty, like somehow her forgiveness was something that should be important to him. But she was just feeling good, all the dancing, such a great evening out watching the moon come up over that fortress, the red wine, the exercise, being with Rowan and being with Rowan's friend, her friend, too—maybe the drugs as well—but she just felt really good and warm and friendly.

He was still circling her, going around backwards and watching her, almost dancing but not, so she stepped in his path and put her hip against his, slipped an arm around his waist. Grady stiffened, put his hand on her back for a moment, smoothing over her skin above the back of her white cotton dress. Then he separated, stepping back. He smiled though, showing her a warm and considerate expression.

“You’re looking real good, Paisley.”

“Thanks,” she said, “this vacation was much needed.”

“You look good with Rowan. Buddy looks happy. I love seeing him with you.”

“He is happy. We’ve been so psyched for this summer, we’re both giddy it’s finally here.”

“I want you to know,” he said, leaning close as the music surged again and the lights changed from cold and white to a deep throbbing blue, “I came for Rowan, he’s my best friend, but I really am so glad to see you, too.” He moved back, smile tucked to one side, again the little boy thing. And, god, he was so cute and charming, this sexy boyishness packed into a grown-up young man’s perfect body, tall and muscular. The expression on his face was so honest, she felt that warm vibing feeling again, imaginary high-tension lines connecting their hearts. Yeah, it was probably the drugs. She laughed, gripped his arm, squeezed it.

She said, “I was worried you weren’t going to show up.”

“Why wouldn’t I show up?”

She left it unsaid. You didn’t show up for when he needed you last fall. Where were you then?

And she didn’t need to say it, Grady licking his lower lip and then looking away. “About that . . .”

She didn’t want to bring the night down, so said, “Rowan doesn’t care.” And that was true.

“I care. I can’t explain . . .”

“Don’t worry about it. Rowan doesn’t, I mean it.”

“I was just going through a thing. I didn’t want to let him down . . .”

The music kicked up even louder, and she began to dance again, moving against Grady, thigh against thigh while they watched Rowan making it through the line now and draining a half-liter bottle of water, bright light behind him, his body in dark muscular profile. She shouted aside, “Ah, don’t worry, Grady, Rowan loves you, you can get away with it. You’re his best friend . . .”

Grady let her dance against him, eyeing her seriously then leaning closer and shouting, “I don’t want this to sound wrong, Paisley, so look at me . . .”

She stayed still, listening, looking at him, Grady getting near her ear again. “I say this with a certain love for you and respect: You’re Rowan’s best friend now.” He pulled back. She stared.

“I didn’t steal him from you.”

He leaned close. “It’s not what I’m saying. I mean it, Rowan is mad about you. You’re all he thinks of. And I couldn’t be happier. For real.”

And while she contemplated the serious meaning Grady seemed to attribute to the fact that her boyfriend was in love with her and she was good for him, Rowan was returning, hair soaking wet for some reason, flaying water at them.

“Let’s go dance,” he shouted. At his chest he held a huge plastic cup with a lid and a straw through it. He was active, dancing in place, taking a sip and passing it to her. “Vodka Red Bull,” he shouted, grabbing Grady and pulling him close to say something in his ear. She sipped through the straw and passed it to Grady, who took his turn.

Rowan danced with her, electric and wild with happy energy. “You ready?”

Grady grabbed Rowan by the neck and put his arm around her waist, leading them to the open church doors saying, “We’re just getting started!”

GRADY

The high wall above the headboard was pale sandy stone, ancient looking, like a fortress wall. Which meant he was upside down in bed.

“Shit,” he sighed, rubbing his eyes with the heel of his hand. Someone’s leg was draped on his chest. Squinted, one eye down, he peeped it was a girl’s bare foot. Had to be Paisley’s.

When he stirred, she stirred, and the foot on his chest lifted, Paisley bending her knee, her knee digging into his ribs, and the movement giving him a flash up her skirt, high along the inside of her thigh almost to her panties. Then he wondered if Paisley wore panties—then felt bad for the raunchy thought about his best friend’s girlfriend.

Head turned to the right now he saw Rowan’s sleeping face; handsome, lips pouted and askew, eyes fluttering in the early morning light with much-needed REM sleep; his chestnut hair stuck up in clumps. He was bare-chested (who knows where his shirt had gone), and his hands gently rested on his sternum. So it was him and Rowan lying with their heads at the bed’s footboard, Paisley in the middle between them, lying face down with her head on a pillow like a normal person.

Now he sat up—and discovered he was also without a shirt. For a flashing moment he was horrified to think something sexual happened last night but was relieved to see he wore shorts, Rowan still wore shorts, and Paisley wore the same dress.

Right, they’d all come stumbling up the apartment’s short steps and into its lounge; he’d gone for the bed, and so did Rowan, both of them climbing up

and talking for a moment while Paisley went for a glass of water in the open concept kitchen right behind him somewhere. They must have passed out, and Paisley climbed up between them.

“Hey,” he said to Paisley, taking hold of her ankle because her foot had come to rest against his chest again, “did you lose your shoes?”

He watched her face in profile on the middle of a satiny orange- and yellow-striped pillow; she frowned as she struggled through sleep to understand his question. “Did I what?—no, I don’t . . . what?”

“You sure?” He thumbed her slender ankle.

It took effort, but she half-lifted her torso, twisting to scowl over her shoulder. “What are you talking about?”

He flicked a finger up her bare foot sole, making her jump and kick, saying, “Your feet are black like you ran through tar.”

Paisley complained and kicked her foot away so hard she kicked her own ass cheek (and he got a peek up her skirt for sure this time—nice pale pink panties, Paisley).

He laughed and swung his feet out of bed, put them on the floor and scratched fingers through his hair, yawned and rose. Paisley sat up cross-legged, pulling a foot sideways to look at the sole saying, “Did I lose my shoes? I hope I didn’t . . .”

PAISLEY

Grady got up from the bed while she checked her feet, trying to remember how they got to bed last night. He walked into the open kitchen, scratching his crotch, rubbing a hand through his hair. There were two sinks set in a marble countertop beneath a vaulted ceiling like a church, and he paused pouring water into a pitcher while watching out the window that looked over a back street on the other side of the townhouse. She rubbed Rowan's hairy calf while Grady returned to the bedroom with two drinking glasses, setting them down on the bedside table saying, "You share with Mr. Morning Wood here."

He poured two glasses of water, laughing to himself, and she checked the front fly of her boyfriend's shorts—Rowan indeed had a raging boner under there, the point of it poking out the fabric below his woven cotton belt.

She chuckled warmly, groaning and hiding her face in her hands a second, saying, "Oh, Rowan," then taking up the pillow she'd rested her head on overnight and lightly whomping it over Rowan's erection. Rowan's knees jumped, and he moaned, exhaled a long breathy sound, then held the pillow over his crotch.

She said to Grady, "He always wakes up with one."

Grady sipped his water, said, "Tell me about it," then laughed.

She said, "What—back at boarding school?"

"That's what we called him at Brinkley: Captain Boner Sunrise."

Eyes closed, Rowan said, “Fuck off—I’m virile. I’m not going to apologize for that.” He clutched a tight grip on the pillow covering his morning boner.

She laughed and rubbed his knee. “Did they call you that?” Now she tweaked his toes.

“No. He’s an idiot—they never called me that,” Rowan said toward the ceiling without opening his eyes.

Grady wandered nearer holding his half drank glass of water, looking down on Rowan, but faces reversed. With wistful charm he said to Rowan: “The young captain sprouts yet another mighty erection to salute the dawn.”

She couldn’t help cackling, then covered her mouth. Grady gently slapped a cupped hand against one of Rowan’s cheeks, then Rowan puffed them out with filled air so Grady’s pats made brief farting noises from his pursed lips. Grady said, “Rise and shine, Captain.”

Rowan sat up and rubbed his eyes while she kissed his bare hot shoulder. Grady walked to a pine plank partition-wall by the bed and admired a painting there, a young woman in a headscarf looking over her shoulder at the viewer, a tourist-shop print of “Girl With A Pearl Earring.”

He said, “Is this Caravaggio?”

“What?” She scoffed, said, “No. It’s Vermeer.” She yawned. “We . . . ah, we went to see the Caravaggio two days ago. It was huge.” The twelve-foot painting depicting the beheading of Saint John the Baptist hung at St. John’s Co-Cathedral here in Valetta, and she and Rowan had checked it out already.

Grady said, “Should I go see it?”

She’d passed Rowan their glass of water and he drank, passed it back to her. He said to Grady, “Go see it if you want to look at a guy with his head chopped off, blood shooting out of it, and like this woman holding a basket for the head to go into.”

Grady blurted air at the gruesome description, turned to face them saying, “Wow. Medieval.” Then he thumbed over his shoulder at the Vermeer. “So why’s this here?”

“Beats me. Maybe they just like it,” she said of the people who’d rented their place out—Caravaggio was a Roman claimed by Malta because he lived here for a spell, but it didn’t mean someone couldn’t like Dutch artists.

Rowan leaned back so he could get a hand in his shorts pocket (flexing his abs, getting her kind of in the mood, thinking he also still had that boner) and pulled out his iPhone. His thumb swiped it awake.

Grady snatched it away and jumped back, making Rowan holler. Grady said, “No way, dude, no way.”

Rowan scowled, said, “No way what?”

Grady held Rowan’s phone against his bare and muscular chest, saying, “No phones today,” then pointed his chin at her saying, “That goes for you, too—Today we’re grabbing our things and going outside, no plans, see where the day takes us . . . no phones, no pictures, no social media stress . . . Guys, today we’re living life . . .”

ROWAN

They had a light breakfast not far from the townhouse in a small and cheap café for young people, splitting avocado and nectarines and fresh mozzarella and bowls of muesli and lots of coffee with cream. Now they were on bikes and heading on the Triq l-Inkurunazzjoni, south of Valetta and along the coast on the other side of the Grand Harbor. They'd borrowed two bikes—no, it was Grady'd who finagled them—from two British backpackers who said they could take them for the day, leave them with friends of theirs who had an apartment in Senglea where they were staying. Which was perfect because Grady said there was a guy with a fishing boat in Senglea who'd take them down to Marsaxlokk, and if they gave the guy forty Euros, they'd save themselves a boring ass trip on the bus.

It'd been a half hour through the medieval streets of Valetta, onto the busier outskirts streets, but now they were back in the twisting fortress narrows of Senglea, passing below a shining gold statue of a woman in flowing robes set on a pedestal, a halo circle of stars around her head, hands held in prayer. Grady ran his bike up onto the empty brick sidewalk and jumped the curb, giving a hoot as his ancient cruiser rattled. But Rowan couldn't follow suit, his bike bigger and bulkier, and Paisley clung to his back, her long legs folded up on either side of his pedaling thighs.

It was an absolutely blazing hot today, and both he and Grady had their shirts unbuttoned and open, Grady's flapping behind him. Paisley's thighs were hot against his legs, and where they connected, the cotton had gone damp. There was something arousing about it; just the feel of his Paisley against him, the fineness of her clinging limbs, the way her chin poked into his back when traffic got busier and she worried.

They raced through the narrow streets of Senglea and out to the outer ring road that ran the Harbour, and when they were out in the sunshine again, Grady reversed the pedals on his bike and brought it to a screeching halt, skidding a crescent and putting out a leg for balance.

He posed for them, standing proud at the low stone wall separating the way from the harbor, a bobbing gang of sails dancing behind him, the narrow waterway at Sanglea packed with boats on this sunny day.

When he pulled alongside, Grady, panting, said, “What was that . . . what was that, huh, number again?”

Paisley got off the saddle and hobbled away like she’d been kicked in the crotch (it probably hadn’t been the most comfortable ride) and began checking the posted numbers on the ancient town homes that ran the Harbor side street. “It’s gotta be that one,” she said, pointing a long brown arm at a door in one of the four-story buildings in stone, mismatched balconies, and a vibrant red painted roll-up shutter door at the ground level.

He said, “You sure that’s the one?” He couldn’t read any numbers.

“They said red door, and remember: there was a painting, like graffiti with some flowers they said, on a rock wall . . .”

Sure enough, next to the town home she’d selected there was a set of steep stone stairs that ran alongside the harbor-front apartments, and up to a street that ran behind it, higher on the rocky island, and on the side of the steep stairs someone had painted flowers on the stone.

He and Grady wheeled the bikes onto the walkway that ran out front of the doorways, and Grady went to the door. The British backpackers’ friends were Maltese and super-friendly, a little older than them but not by much, and they were invited in to eat, but they said they wanted to go south along the coast. The Maltese were happy to point out which of the fishermen along the busy harbor side would take tourists to Marsaxlokk. They left then with lots of waving and promises they’d all try to hook up tonight, go out and have fun in Valetta, but he wasn’t sure if they’d really make it; they

only had one more night together, then Grady was heading to Greece, and they were going to Spain.

PAISLEY

The fisherman didn't take them to Marsaxlokk. Instead, he told them of a better spot that was more fun and wouldn't be full of tourists. They'd wanted to go swimming at St. Peter's Pool, a natural rock formation filled with crystal clear water, but this grizzled guy said his destination was better. And quieter. In half an hour he had the boat's blating diesel motor chugging them into a small, quiet cove. The fisherman's boat was painted in bright blue with yellow trim, red and green stripes on its side; up front the boat had two eyeballs painted, like bird's eyes, and the fisherman told them they were the eyes of Horus and they kept fishermen safe.

Most of the journey the guy'd stayed in the boat's hut, warding them off by chain-smoking. But he spoke great English, coming out now and telling them this was the spot, going near the bow and proudly waving a hand at the rocky coastline like he owned it.

Rowan said it was beautiful, putting his arm around her—but when the guy made no more move it was Grady saying, "You can't get us any closer, can you?"

The fisherman saw no problem, laughing and saying, "You swim," making the motion of a dive from the boat.

They were all dressed, and they hadn't thought they'd be swimming, thusly they had no suits, no towels . . . She groaned, said, "This is why we should bring phones, Grady, we'd—"

But Grady was stripping his shirt off already, saying, "If we had phones, Paisley, we couldn't swim to shore now, could we?" which made Rowan

laugh and he stripped his own shirt off.

She said, “Why are you taking your shirts off?—they’re going to get wet anyway.” Showing off their bodies was why.

The cove was steep walled, low rocky cliffs in multiple levels walling it in, a thin half-moon of white sand beach. But the water in the cove was bright turquoise—crystal clear when you looked down. The spot was indeed beautiful.

The fisherman said if they got tired of swimming and wanted to leave they could scramble up the cliff—said it was hard to negotiate but they were young—or if they hung tight, he’d be coming back this way around five o’clock and could pick them up (for another ferry fare back to Senglea).

The fisherman gave them a grubby plastic Ziploc baggie from inside his hut, and they put all their ID and cash in it, and Rowan tucked it down the front of his underwear (and Grady thought that was hilarious). Grady was the first one in: no hesitation, he hiked a leg over the boat’s railing, sidestepped on the other side, then did a backflip facing them. The fisherman applauded, cigarette plugged into his squinting, stubbled face.

Rowan held her hand, saying, “Let’s go, Paisley . . .”

She surrendered, making an exasperated sound and joining her boyfriend on the other side of the railing. They both leapt out feet first and swooped under the water—which was surprisingly warm but still refreshing. It rushed up the legs of her shorts and flooded around her panties. It soothed her aching crotch. The awkward bike ride and uncomfortable saddle had done a number on her lady.

They bobbed to Grady, his thick hair slicked back from his handsome face. Grady said to her, “I can’t think of anything more boring than coming out here with swimsuits, taking an Uber or something—this is way better . . .”

“Yeah, way better,” she said, and cupped two handfuls of water into Grady’s face. But maybe it was kind of fun.

GRADY

Not that it was a race, but he was the first one to shore, feet finding silky soft sand, then bouncing and bobbing, hollering for his friends to catch up. Trying to keep the mood high—for Rowan’s sake, but for Paisley’s, too. Rowan could sometimes be prone to worry. And the thing Rowan worried about most was Paisley. It was important for Paisley to have a good time. And he wanted that, too, waving them into shore now, standing on the beach and helicoptering his wet shirt above his head.

As Paisley and Rowan found their feet and emerged from the water with their clothes soaking, he tossed his shirt a half dozen feet where it flapped against a low hump of cliff rock. He shouted to them, “Can you believe this place?” His voice echoed off the cove’s rock walls.

He was glad to see their expressions energized and happy. Both of them coming up now through the sand, Rowan running his hair back from his face, and Paisley’s tension erased, replaced with a big wide smile (and two cheery nipple dots in her white tank top that had him thinking bad things again about his best friend’s girlfriend).

“Nobody else,” he said, pointing at both of them, “comes here and find a spot like this. Just us.”

“It is pretty fucking awesome,” Paisley said with a laugh, bent over and squeezed the seawater out of her long hair.

Rowan flicked his head to the side like he had water in his ear saying, “You were right.”

They clasped hands, thumbs interlocking, and he slapped Rowan's shoulder. "I only get two days with my best friend—we're going to make them count."

Rowan moved on, walking to the low cliff rock where his shirt had been flung, squeezing the water out of his own shirt as he went then laying it out flat on the rock, tugging its corners and making it straight. He crossed his arms, and said to Paisley, "Rowan was always such a good roommate."

"He's tidier than I am."

"Yeah," he said, "most girls are pigs."

Paisley thumped his arm and laughed. "Such an asshole. But, yeah . . ."

"I remember your roommate at Iris Duncan."

"We had to get our room treated for black mold."

He nodded to Rowan still flattening his shirt so it would dry in the sun. "That wouldn't happen on Rowan's watch."

"Not my man," she said, folding her arms and standing next to him, both of them watching Rowan.

"Your roommate was a pig, but goddam she was hot."

"Oh, yeah? She was infatuated with you."

"She never said anything."

"I forbade it."

He let his arms hang apish. "Paisley," he complained, "Me and what's-her-name could have been meant for each other."

Paisley laughed, said, "I didn't want to see you with any of my friends."

"Jealous?"

Paisley looked surprised by his question—which he’d meant as a joke. And now he felt spotlighted, like she’d caught a glimpse at something he didn’t want seen. Her mouth swished aside and she seemed to contemplate her answer before saying, “It would bug me. Yeah, I admit it.”

ROWAN

He flattened Grady's shirt too, next to his own, letting them bake in the scorching sun. He said now, "These'll dry fast." Turned then, saying, "I'm taking my shorts off, going in my skivvies."

Grady and Paisley joined him, Grady saying, "Your skivvies are going to be wet when your shorts are dry. What are you going to do, swap them out, go back on the boat without your panties?" Paisley laughed at the word "panties" and sat on the rock, squeezing out her hair again.

"Oh, I don't know . . . What are we doing, going skinny dipping?"

Paisley scoffed behind her hanging wet hair. Then she lifted her head, showing them her face and an expression of contemplation. "I could even out my tan."

He said to Grady, "Paisley wants to go back to Princeton like a leather shoe."

"I love your tan," Grady said.

Paisley put out her long legs saying, "Thank you, Grady. And it's only been a week. And when I go back I want to look like I've been somewhere, you know?—I just spent the last eight months in lecture halls and dorms and the library. I looked like dough."

He had a strangely exciting thought: There was an unusual thing to consider, and he didn't know how to feel about it. But it made him think . . . So he stood up and undid his shorts and let them fall while Grady and Paisley watched his unexpected strip performance. Now that he had their

attention, he patted his underwear bulge made huge by the plastic baggie with all their important and dry things. It got them laughing. He kicked off his shorts, and they landed on the rock next to Paisley. He straightened them out to dry. Hands on hips, he said, “So we’re going buck?”

Paisley said to him, “Are you going buck?”

“I’ll go buck. Grady, I know you’ll go buck.”

Grady nodded, said to Paisley, “You going buck, Paisley?”

“I guess I am.”

Grady said, “You don’t have to . . .”

She said, “When in Malta . . .”

He pulled out the plastic pack from his underwear and threw it next to his clothes, then pulled down his underwear, and naked now, lay his briefs out on the rock. Paisley watched him, and it was arousing to be naked in front of her this way, even though he’d been naked with her countless times before. He turned to face the water saying, “I bet we could go and get up on those rocks,” pointing to a rise of flattish rock humps arranged in tiers like steps, “dive off from there.”

Grady agreed, and when he turned Paisley was poised like she’d take off her shirt but was hesitating, waiting to see if Grady would join in, and the way she watched Grady—poised like he would unbutton his shorts—made him wonder if she’d already heard something about Grady. It also made him wonder if he should say something beforehand or not mention it because it would be lame to mention it, or maybe if he wanted her to be skinny-dipping at all with him if Grady was around . . .

Grady was looking at him, meeting his eyes, saying, “Are we doing this—are you sure?”

And since he was directly addressed, he knew the question was just for him and knew Grady was trying to be respectful . . .

He chuckled, shook his head saying, “Yeah, just show her . . .”

Grady made no reaction but drew down his zipper, then stayed where he was and thumb-shoved his pants and underwear to his knees, then stepped out of them. The whole while Paisley had watched—probably been made curious by his just show her statement—and it seemed like she hadn’t heard any rumors about Grady because her reaction seeing Grady’s huge penis was genuine shock. Her eyes flashed, she looked startled, and she instantly threw up a hand to block the sight of it, looking away saying, “Holy shit, Grady, fucking warn somebody, I was not ready for that.” Now she laughed nervously, looking his way, hand still held up. He shook his head at her antics.

Grady was unfazed, coming next to her completely naked, stooping and laying out his soaking wet shorts and underwear. And Paisley took another look at his penis, this time from the side, mouth poised open with shocked amusement, brow lowered, disbelieving, fingers clasped together.

Grady indeed had a huge penis, something he was already aware of being in boarding school for four years with him, being his roommate for four years, being in athletics with the guy, being his best friend . . . but he wasn’t jealous seeing Paisley ogle it—for some reason he was amused. It was Grady.

Grady stepped back, saying to Paisley, “Are you coming up the rock with us?” like he was past the big dick thing already—probably was, the guy had the dick his whole life.

But Paisley wasn’t past it; her hand went up again to block Grady’s penis from her vision, but she was all girl-giggles and blushing cheeks and chest. “Yeah-yeah,” she said, “give me a minute to get myself together . . .”

He came to stand next to Grady, both of them naked, waiting for her. He looked over at Grady’s penis, said to Paisley, “And I think that’s shrunk.”

Paisley stood, hands down but looking at the sky saying, “That’s shrunk?”

Grady said, “Yeah, it shrunk because I was in the water.”

“That’s shrunk?” She still spoke skyward but now pulled up on her tank top showing them her bare flat stomach, then her bra and her bead necklaces. She tossed the shirt aside.

He said to Grady, “You rattled her.”

“I’m not rattled,” she said, unbuttoning her shorts, still averting her eyes.

Grady said, “If it offends you, feel free not to look at it, Paisley.”

She rolled her eyes, said, “I’m not offended . . .” She unzipped her shorts, let them fall, stood now in her bra and panties and for some reason his heart really started to pound and he wanted to take a seat. Paisley’s eyes lowered as she put her hands behind her back and unhooked her bra. “It’s just . . .” She gave Grady’s penis yet another good long look while she let her straps fall, and then pulled her bra off, letting him and Grady see her bare breasts, her dark nipples pulled taut. She still stared, nose crinkled; Grady wagged his hips, getting his oversized organ to bounce and sway, making light tapping noises against his thighs. Paisley rolled her eyes and laughed. “That is . . . that’s a really big dick.”

PAISLEY

Faced with two gorgeous and naked dudes was a little overwhelming at first, but now she was comfortable—and honestly happy to be in their presence. Even naked. Almost naked.

But that had been a genuine surprise to see the size of Grady's penis. Sometimes when he would sit, there'd be a bulge that maybe made her think he could be packing. But she hadn't anticipated huge. It literally looked like a colorless banana, a big one, fat, sprouting out from between his legs and curving down. It bounced and swung in a way that made her think it really was shrunk from the cold; like it might be bigger and swingier if they hadn't been swimming. And it was oddly smooth and faceless. Rowan was circumcised, but Grady wasn't, and it was unfamiliar to her, the way all the skin bunched up at the end and you could kind of see the head-shape underneath.

Grady said, "Homeboy's got a great dick," thumbing to Rowan, who didn't seem bothered by the attention she was sending Grady's penis's way.

"Rowan's got a great dick," she said, prideful, adding: "A big dick, and I worship it . . ."

She'd been walking braless toward them, and at her words Rowan wrangled her and pulled her in an embrace. She said to Grady over her shoulder: "How do you know about 'Homeboy's' dick?"

Grady said, "I know what his dick looks like—every morning that thing saluting the sun, poking up his bedsheets." He made a fist and flexed his muscular forearm, indicating Rowan's upright morning wood.

Rowan was hard—halfway at least—she could feel it poking her stomach. She stepped back, laughing. “Rowan, you’re getting hard . . .”

Now it was Rowan wagging his hips, making his Semi wag back and forth. “I’m fucking virile, I told you. Try to stop me—you can’t.”

“God, Rowan,” she said, feeling embarrassed (but strangely turned on), wondering how their fun skinny-dipping got so sexual so fast. But as she stepped to the shore, Grady called after her: “You’re wearing your panties? You don’t want to take those off?”

She turned and put a hand down between her legs, making a funny face and saying, “I didn’t exactly . . . landscape, if you know what I mean. It’s hard to keep up when you’re backpacking . . .”

Rowan gave her an “Aw, baby . . .” and pouted.

Grady said, “Get rid of ’em, Paisley, I’ve never been afraid of some bush—I like it.”

She said, “Well, it’s not whether you like it as the reason I feel weird . . .”

“Fine, wear them,” Grady said, shrugging, then pointing a jabbing finger at her saying, “but anytime I hear you tell someone how you went skinny-dipping in Malta, I’m going to call you out, add a little footnote you probably won’t like.”

She rolled her eyes, but was thinking it was funny how his big dick wagged in time with his talking like it was backing him up. She laughed.

Rowan said, “Get the panties off and let’s do this right, Paisley—and you know your ass is white as the moon.”

“Fine-yes,” she said, and legs straight, she scooped forward, bent at the waist and pulled her panties off, walking past the boys with her panties held out, and one hand covering her shaggy muff. She put her panties on the rock to dry in the sun and she heard Grady say to Rowan, “That is one super-white ass,” and Rowan laughed. She slapped her own butt, then shook it a

little—totally surprised how a funny heavy feeling had settled low in her belly, a soggy grapefruit-sized ball of desire hanging above her hairy lady. She hadn't expected these feelings going swimming with Rowan and Grady. If it were just Rowan, she would expect it, but not when their friend was along.

But it was Grady she'd dated first. Then Grady introduced her to Rowan. They weren't even seventeen then. She'd gone out a few times with Grady, but nothing ever happened between them other than he held her hand one time when she visited Manhattan. For a while she'd been teen-girl smitten with gorgeous Grady. But he never came up to Hartford, and she was pretty sure he was already kind of seeing this other girl who also lived in Manhattan. Grady called her one time, a total gentleman, said he was seeing this other girl now (as she'd suspected) and he wanted her to know. And then literally set her up with his roommate, Rowan, who he assured her was a perfect match. "You guys are, like, the same guys," he'd said. And Grady was a hundred percent right. She could never, ever picture herself with anyone other than Rowan. They were indeed of the same mind.

At first she couldn't help walking with her hands in her armpits, forearms folded over her bare breasts, and taking short steps, narrow strides where her knees were practically touching. But Grady and Rowan only mildly ogled her, then began plotting their route up the rocks to get to the sheer cliff drop-off where they would dive. By the time they were setting foot on the rocks, she'd let her nakedness go uncovered.

Together, they scrambled up the rocks, totally naked, sometimes walking, sometimes climbing on a low angle where they were practically on all fours. And looking at Rowan and Grady's gorgeous naked boy bodies was making that soggy desirous feeling heavier and soggier. Both of them with tight and white round boy asses. Muscles flexing, sweat-shiny humps of muscle working on their strong backs, both of them lean with narrow waists, big shoulders and pumped up arms. And the nudity . . .? When they would get ahead of her—which she let them do—she would look up and admire them. Grady's huge hairy dangling package, from behind getting a look at his bunched up red-brown ball sack (also larger than average). And Rowan? Her familiar man's genitals aroused and engorged . . . When they

would go on all fours, it was Rowan on three points, using his right hand to protect his erection from dragging its sensitive tip on the scratchy rocks.

At the crest, it was Grady waiting for her, stooping and lowering a hand to help her. She put her hand in his and he pulled her up to join them, her face coming very near the thing swinging between his legs, but then she was up, falling into Rowan's arms who embraced her, his erection pressed flat against her stomach.

GRADY

Paisley's body was driving him out of his mind. He'd been thinking of wrestling holds, calculus, his grandma . . . anything to prevent what was happening between Rowan's legs from happening between his legs. That would be embarrassing. And worse: rude. Disrespectful to his best friend—getting an erection over his girl. Or: Could it be a compliment to Paisley? Shit, he'd rather not find out. Just don't get an erection, he told himself.

But Paisley's naked body was going to make that impossible.

He turned then, left Rowan and Paisley behind him and walked near the cliff edge, shielding his eyes from the sun and staring out across sparkling cobalt Mediterranean, eyes rolling downward, watching the sea brighten close to shore, becoming a twinkling wave-dashed turquoise. But in his mind's eye, that dark part of his brain couldn't erase the image of naked Paisley. Long legs, that tan, that beautiful shade . . . the way her wet hair hung on her collar and down her slender back. Hard nipples, the shape of her breasts, their uprightness, the cherry-caramel shade of her aureoles. And this was where he was going to get himself in trouble . . .

He said toward the Mediterranean, "We've got this view all to ourselves, guys . . ."

He turned, enjoying seeing Rowan and Paisley embracing still, Rowan still sprouting turgid arousal, his hardness angled along Paisley's tight stomach. Paisley's white-happy smile was making his heart ache. He hadn't thought of her like this in so long.

There was a time when he thought he might have fallen in love with Paisley. And it scared him so much. He wasn't in the right place then—his mom in the hospital, his father on a rampage and drinking again. He knew that he would only end up wrecking things with Paisley. And in the end, he'd turned to Megan that year, and he was exactly right—look how terrible things ended with Megan. You could've done that to sweet Paisley. No, he'd made the right decision. It was better to keep her preserved. And in some strange surging of his twanging heartstrings back then, he'd set Paisley up with his best friend and roommate, Rowan. A day later, his stomach hurt from regret. Wishing he hadn't done it, then cursing himself knowing it was the right thing to do. And secretly he thought: didn't you set her up with Rowan just so she would still be in your life? And that was true. Because if he'd dropped things with Paisley and just gone with Megan, Paisley would've left him for good. But while he was with Megan, his best friend Rowan was with Paisley. He saw her on the weekends when she'd come by to spend time with Rowan, and those first weekends were awful. Seeing that sweet girl that had set his heart on fire with Rowan. Seeing them getting along so well. But as the months went by, he grew accustomed. Jealousy and heartache was eventually replaced with happiness. Sure, it would rear up occasionally, but mostly he was genuinely happy for them. He'd meant what he said to Paisley, saying how she and Rowan were meant for each other, were practically the same.

Five years later and it was obvious he'd done the right thing, so the days filled with regret should be in the past now. But they weren't. He'd left a devastating casualty-strewn battlefield in his love life in that time. If he hadn't quit her, Paisley would just be one of those practically nameless dead . . .

Paisley: "What are you smiling about?"

Startled, he looked at them, both of them staring at him, puzzled. He said, "Oh—I guess I went away there."

Paisley said, "Where did you go?" stepping away from Rowan, revealing her nudity again, her breasts swaying, those nipples still bursting like ripe fruit. And oh shit, it was going to happen—he could feel an ache between

his legs, right behind his testicles, the heavy weight of his manhood seeking to lift . . .

ROWAN

Grady performed for them his second impromptu backflip of the day. Both hands up and pointing fingers at each of them, smirking, two steps backward, dick bouncing, jumped off the cliff face, arms outstretched, arcing backwards, sunlight glinting off his stretched back abs. Then, knees tucking up, he somersaulted, showing his balls and ass. Paisley gave a bright chirping sound of surprise. The cliff height wasn't crazy, twenty feet, thirty at the most . . . Both of them made it to curl their bare toes over the edge and witness his body pierce the water below, the sound of the splash a second and a half behind.

Paisley hooted loud, cupped her hands to her mouth and shouted, "Go, Grady!" but Grady wasn't even at the surface yet. They could see him doing a breaststroke under the water, perfectly visible in the crystal clear cove water. Now as Grady broke the surface, through cupped hands again, Paisley shouted, "You're crazy!"

Grady treaded water, brushing hair back from his face, and shouted encouragement for them to join him.

He said to Paisley, "Scared?"

"Not one bit," she said, all her bristly defense in the fishing boat completely washed away, his girl definitely having fun.

She took his hand, and he said, "We're doing this together?"

"We do everything together," she said.

On the count of three, they dipped their knees then jumped, Paisley hollering the whole way down. The water exploded in their eardrums, and his hand came apart from hers, water whirling from his nostrils in huge bubbling torrents. Then he was kicking, thrashing his arms in a clumsy breaststroke, trying to get through the wake of his own entrance into the sea. His fingers flicked against Paisley's fingers, and his heart swelled knowing she was near. They broke the water together, but Grady was farther off, already paddling back to the beach, heading to do another dive. He swam after, but Paisley hooked her forearm around his neck and her naked body slithered against his back. He could feel the hard nubs of her nipples grazing on his skin. She bit his ear, and he laughed, stopping his forward motion, turning and paddling with her. They embraced, and Paisley kissed him with unambiguous passion that got his heart racing. He ran his hands on her back, the natural oils on her sweaty skin making his palms slide like silk up and down her corrugated ribs. He completely and totally ached for her suddenly. When their mouths parted, he looked in her eyes. "What was that for?"

"Because I love you."

"I love you, too," he said, and they both smiled and looked in each other's sparkling eyes.

Now she was glancing around, surreptitious, like she was up to something. She said, "We should sneak off . . ."

"What do you want to do?"

She worked her hand between them, grabbed his erection in the middle and squeezed it. His eyes fluttered, and he groaned. "I need this so bad right now," she said.

"Should we do it right here?" he said, kidding.

"Grady's here . . ."

He said, "We can't sneak off."

She knew he was right, made an uncomfortable face, like she had a cramp, saying, “I need it so bad right now.”

“You’re getting hot with two naked guys around, huh?”

“It’s you walking around with this,” she said, stroking him again. “Seeing this thing bouncing around and you acting like it’s not even there is making me so hot . . .”

“Well,” he said, “you’re going to have to find some way to cool off—we can’t sneak away, it would be so rude . . .”

“You don’t want to put in me right now?” She smirked, and he could tell she was joking.

He said, “Not with Grady watching.”

“It is kind of rude, I guess . . .”

She pecked his lips, let him go, and began to paddle. She shouted over her shoulder, “At least you know how horny you got me.”

He laughed, watching sunlight glint on her liquid wet skin, so in love with her, so happy with her . . . but knowing deep down it wasn’t only him who’d aroused her.

PAISLEY

Eleven times they jumped, swam, then climbed back up to the cliff edge. It was enough for her, and on the twelfth stop at the cliff's edge she chose to let the boys continue without her.

She'd sunbathe instead, sitting and hugging her knees for a few minutes first, feeling the hot sun on her back while she enjoyed the view out over the Mediterranean. The sun was so hot she felt her back dry in almost a minute. Squeezed out her hair then, the boys returning up the rocky face, laughing, and she watched them. Admired them. Both of them were so much fun. So beautiful. Beautiful people, and beautiful to look at, too. All glistening muscle and nude male perfection.

She couldn't help smiling, running her hair back, turning her face up to the sun and listening to them jump, yell, then splash into the water below. She turned then, thinking of her too-white bottom, and lay face down on the hot rock, resting her cheek on her folded over forearms. The sun was amazing on her naked skin. The boys came up again, laughing, commenting on her bare ass which she wagged for them; then they jumped off the ledge again. One more time they came up, and then she was sure she drifted off.

Not sure how long she was out, but she was groggy when woken by somebody touching her bare ass. It was Rowan, saying, "Getting kind of pink there, baby."

She turned to see him leaning on an elbow and laying next to her. She looked down her backside, could see that the white bikini triangle shape on her bare ass had indeed gone a little pink.

“Time to flip over,” Rowan said.

She agreed, rolling over, laying back but up on her elbows. Grady stood at the cliff’s edge, admiring the view. She admired Grady. She said to Rowan, “Are you guys done?”

“We’re taking a break,” he said.

“That’s good,” she said, “I’m getting hungry.”

Grady asked, “Are we going to wait for the fisherman?”

“Maybe we should head into that fishing village. We can probably get something to eat there,” Rowan said.

She asked the time and Rowan said, “The fisherman will be back in like two hours. What do you want to do?”

She said, “I want to get some sun on my front first. But I am hungry. How do you think we get there?”

Grady returned into her field of vision, walking along the cliff edge now and pointing out toward the crescent beach below. A steady trail of water droplets dripped from his foreskin. “I think there’s a trail that runs up that rock there where our clothes are drying. Scramble up that rock, probably climb up that one there, that one that looks like a V—up that V and then over.”

“Sounds good,” Rowan said, and imitated her, laying back now and propped up on his elbows. His hair was wet and slicked back, one long lock bouncing on his handsome brow.

She leaned over and kissed his shoulder, and he kissed her hairline and cupped her cheek. Between his legs, she could see that his arousal had faded. He wasn’t fully soft, but he looked less urgent now. Upright, a little full and plump looking, but laying flat on his hard stomach. She kissed his nipple and lay back down on her elbows.

Grady came over and lay on the other side so she was in between them. He too sat back on his elbows. The way he did that made his shoulders look huge, run with striated muscle. And his big penis flopped against his thigh, lolling over and pointed her way. It looked so much different from Rowan's; stranger, but with a certain curious appeal. It had a slug-like bottom-of-the-sea creature grotesqueness: plump, almost bloated, the way it was so smooth and then with that wrinkled folded-up unseeing eye at the end. But it had sexual allure, and she had to warn herself that she better stop looking at it before Rowan or Grady noticed her checking it out.

She lay back, closed her eyes, said, "What do you think we can get to eat at the fishing village?"

Rowan said, "Fish?"

Grady laughed. She opened her eyes and turned to see him, picking up small rocks and tossing them the half dozen feet to the cliff edge. "Maltese sushi," he chuckled.

Rowan said, "I'm sure they cook it first."

Grady said, "I could totally go for some fish and chips."

She said, "We should go to Scotland."

"Too cold," Grady said, throwing another pebble. He turned to look at her, gave her a smile. She smiled back, but noticed his flickering eyes had been dancing over her naked body. And all of a sudden that heavy slithering feeling returned between her legs. A squirming nest of snakes just below her stomach that got her flexing her butt muscles against the hard and jagged rock. She closed her eyes again, letting sexy Grady look if he wanted. But now she imagined him looking. Hoping he would like what he saw. Rowan sure did, Rowan couldn't keep his hands off of her. Would Grady feel the same urge?

They were all quiet for a while, and she heard Rowan lay down, and then on the other side Grady lay down as well. Only, when she peeped to the side to look at Grady again, there were changes to that shapeless thing laying on

his leg. It was moving. Rolling against his thigh, squirming, the shape of his cock head moving underneath his foreskin as it grew upward toward his hip, the big thing looking weird like it wanted to turn inside out. It rolled over against his hip bone, the foreskin unrolling. But then Grady shifted uncomfortably, as if he realized there was something happening between his legs, too. Grady was getting an erection like Rowan had. He rolled away from her, onto his side, showing off his bright white perfect boy ass. Then rolled right over, getting on his knees and hands for a moment, that thing between his legs not shrunken anymore at all, hanging down huge, filling the gap between his thighs, past half way to his knees. He put his hand on it to tuck it downward and then lay on his stomach.

And now suddenly that feeling in her stomach was a thousand times more urgent. It felt like a cramp, and she sat up abruptly, hugged her knees again. Looked aside to Grady, his legs slightly parted, his dick laying on the rock, visible between his parted legs. She looked away, brushed her hair back again, turned and lay against Rowan, hugging his narrow waist and then kissing his ribs. He hugged an arm around her and she worked her way up his body, kissed his cheek, whispered in his ear, "Do you want to go . . . swimming . . . together?"

His lashes fluttered, and he looked at her. Their eyes met, and she bit her lower lip. He smiled too, and she kissed his mouth.

ROWAN

Before he could say anything, Paisley was kissing his mouth. He kissed her in return, but she was hungry and gave him her tongue. She scratched at his cheek, played with his earlobe. He touched her shoulder, and then down her back and her ribs. Her nipples scratched on his skin. She hooked a leg over his leg, the front of her thigh touching his scrotum, and then she sandwiched his right foot with both of her feet, one sole playing over the top of his foot, teasing him, and now humping her sex against the outside of his thigh. Paisley was horny. And he loved when Paisley was horny.

In a few beats of his heart, his erection had returned completely. His stomach tightened, and Paisley ran her hand over his muscle. But now he saw Grady rising from behind Paisley, standing up, moving toward the cliff edge.

“Hey,” he said, feeling guilty, and when Grady half-turned, he saw that his friend had grown an erection as well. An enormous horse-like thing between his legs. Paisley turned, and she saw it too. How could she miss it? And the fact that Paisley was looking at his best friend so aroused—so impressive—made him want to hold her tight, make love to her more, but not mad at her at all in any way. Somehow aroused by it. Their three-way relationship had strange and mysterious vectors.

Paisley asked Grady what he was doing.

Grady said, “Giving you guys some space,” turned and jumped off the cliff edge.

Paisley rested her cheek against his shoulder. “Shoot,” she said in the moment before they heard him splash far below. She rose, holding onto his hand, encouraging him to rise, too. And he did, agreeing with her that they didn’t want Grady to leave them alone so they could have sex.

At the cliff edge, Paisley said to him, “I don’t want Grady to feel like a third wheel.”

“Me neither,” he said, and they dipped their knees and on the count of three jumped together again, letting their hands go as they hit the water. When they came up, Grady was swimming ashore. They didn’t call after him, but pursued him.

One second they took to share some togetherness, and they hurt their friend’s feelings—they’d had sex every day this trip, they couldn’t take a day off? But it had been Paisley who was the instigator . . .

As they got to shore and found their footing, they strode out of the water, water sloughing off their naked bodies in torrents, moving quick. “Grady, wait up . . .”

Grady turned, one hand holding his arousal against his thigh—obviously embarrassed that he was aroused. He said, “You guys go do what you want . . .” Trying to be magnanimous, saying the right thing, but a weird hurt sort of look in his eyes.

Paisley said, “We don’t want that.”

Grady said, “Guys, come on—I want you two to have time together if you need it.”

“No,” he said to Grady, “we are having together time. Don’t worry about it . . .”

Paisley said, “Yeah, it’s okay . . .”

Grady was smiling, still holding his huge erection against his leg. “Guys, it’s not a big deal—”

Paisley said, “No, it’s not a big deal. That’s why I don’t want to be awkward like this. We were just kissing a little . . .”

“It was more than kissing,” Grady said. “Come on . . . You guys were about to do it—Rowan’s got yet another erection, like the tenth one today . . .”

It was quiet a moment, and he didn’t know what to say. Paisley spoke up, her voice a little light with laughter, but still tense with . . . something he couldn’t put his finger on. “You’ve got one, too,” she said, nodding her chin between his legs. Then: “What does that mean?” Paisley acknowledging to them all she’d seen Grady’s erection.

The way it thrilled him caught him off guard and his heart raced faster thinking of Paisley seeing such an intimate part of another man. And her behavior . . .? . . . her sudden horniness was provoked by Grady and his nudity, maybe the size of his friend’s genitals. Would that arouse his Paisley? And why would he like that?

Grady’s hand moved along his length, gripping it, trying to hide it (but it was impossible to hide). “Don’t weird me out,” Grady said in a quiet voice after a long pause as he tried to come up with an answer. “You guys go back up there, bang one out and I’ll just swim around . . .”

GRADY

The whole day went awkward all of a sudden, and maybe he shouldn't have dove off the cliff—but what was he supposed to do, lay there next to them while they got it on? Not when he'd been unable to hold back the beast of his passion for Paisley any longer. Thought he'd got past it, but as soon as he'd sat next to her naked body laid out, vulnerable because her eyes were closed, his heart had begun pumping hard for her. Up close and looking at her skin, the wiry shadows cast on her vulva by her pubic hair (where he should never have been looking), the shallow scoop of her navel dented on that lean stomach, the way the tightness of her nipples pulled on the creamy skin of her breasts, the way those pert breasts struggled to stay pert when she lay on her back, easing their heft to the side . . . his resolve to not get hard had been hobbled. He got hard. Then Rowan and Paisley got hot and heavy and he got out of there.

He said, "Sorry about . . . this," giving two squeezes on his erection, wishing it would go away, but at the same time hyper-aware of Paisley's eyes on it (and wanting her to look at it), "I couldn't help it."

Rowan laughed, said, "Now I don't feel so out of place," looking down at his erection thrust up and wagging stiffly.

"It's okay, Grady," Paisley said, her eyes on his now, trying to show him she really meant it with an earnest open expression.

This erection was never going to go away. Just the sight of her made his stomach ache. And now there were clicks in the back of his mind, someone banging rocks together trying to get a fire started . . . All three of them friends, Paisley naked, Paisley accepting of his erection, and Rowan hard as

a rock . . . It was impossible, but he couldn't help feeling that something could happen here . . . And it was Rowan now, extending a hand out, waving him to join them saying, "It's cool, Grady, come on, we'll all go swimming."

Paisley liked the idea, stepping forward, reaching out and taking his hand. His erection was released and bounced between his legs, and Paisley regarded it quickly, then Rowan led the way, and Paisley walked him deeper into the water. He had to admit, it was making him feel better, making him feel included. It's not that he felt excluded . . .

Paisley said, "I don't want you to feel like a third wheel."

"I don't," he said, sensing the feel of her slippery hand in his, "it's not that I felt excluded—I was somewhere I shouldn't feel included . . ."

Rowan dove into the deeper water, his white ass flashing for a second, and then he was gone. Paisley still held his hand, leading him deeper to join Rowan. She faced him as the water came to their chests, took both his hands, leaned back and began flutter kicking, and he could feel the current of her kicks bouncing his testicles around between his legs.

As they swam out, Paisley climbed around his body and got on his back. She hugged him, and they paddled out to join Rowan. Rowan said, "We really couldn't ask for a more perfect day," squinting up at the sun.

"It's true," Paisley said near his ear, then she climbed around his body, and her leg—from her calf to mid-thigh—slid between his legs, her body actually touching his throbbing erection. He was sure she'd done it on purpose. Without Rowan's knowledge. It squeezed at his stomach. Wanting her so bad, curious to know if she wanted him the same way, but fear for the sanity of his best friend.

After her leg had touched his cock, she didn't shy away. Turning to face him, her knee caught on his erection and pushed it to the side. She knew what her knee had touched.

She said, “You had the best idea today,” then paddled backwards, her breasts and nipples showing, warbling inches from the seawater surface. Rowan embraced her, their faces side-by-side, Paisley smiling at him and tightening her grip on his heart. Rowan kissed her cheek, then dipped below the water. Something he did made Paisley yelp and giggle, and she laughed. Rowan bobbed up a half dozen feet from them.

Paisley circled to find him, then paddled backward to join Grady, his heartbeat throbbing in his ears. He put his hand on the middle of Paisley’s back, and they got side-by-side, Rowan bobbed watching them and there was a certain excitement in his friend’s eyes . . .

ROWAN

Was this really going to happen? Did he even want it to happen? He was pretty sure he did. Or at least his body was pretty sure. He was throbbing hard, his cock driven into singing steel by his girlfriend holding Grady's hand, both of them naked. He'd dove out to get away from them, so he could turn and see them together better. His two best friends in his whole life. They were side-by-side, naked under the water.

Nothing had been planned here, but he was sure it was happening. Would Paisley want this? She loved Grady. But loved him like a friend. They'd dated when she was sixteen and nothing happened—not even a kiss, she'd said. He was sure Grady wanted this. And he was sure he wanted it. But they were guys. Guys want this sort of thing. Paisley wouldn't want this—so he was giving her space to let her decide. He knew she was at least curious.

And seeing them so close together now, he imagined Paisley's hands could be on Grady under the water where he couldn't see. Touching his chest and stomach, maybe even between his legs. Maybe he was sure he wanted her to.

Paisley and Grady talked close, but he couldn't hear them. Both of them laughing. Their bodies were against each other. Now he waded closer until all three of their faces were only feet apart. He reached under the water and took Paisley's hand. She held Grady's hand on the other side. He pulled to get them all closer. And none of them knew what to say. All of them feeling like this thing was going to happen, but nobody wanting to be the first to say it. Both guys checking each other out, then looking to the one who had

the final say: Paisley. And he could tell by his girlfriend's expression the answer wasn't no. Paisley knew it was happening too.

He said, "Kiss him . . ."

Paisley looked shocked, then giggled. Grady groaned, looked away for a second.

Paisley rubbed her eyes, blinked. Looked directly in his into his eyes. She said, "You want me to kiss him?"

He said, "Do it."

Paisley chewed her lower lip for a second, the waves bobbing them up and down, looked to Grady and said, "Rowan wants me to kiss you."

Grady looked in her eyes now. He said, "You can do that."

"You're not gonna be mad?" Paisley said, then laughed awkwardly.

Grady got closer, looking like he'd put his hands on her waist. They were face to face, Paisley held the sides of Grady's neck, taking her time like she wasn't sure she would do this—but he knew she would do it. As their mouths came together, Grady looked hungry for it, but Paisley looked like she was trying not to burst out laughing. Their mouths connected, their lips mushing together, heads angling. Then it was done, Paisley letting Grady's face go and bobbing away, licking her lower lip.

All of them had half smiles now, looking at each other, and Grady said to Paisley, "What did you think?"

"It was pretty good," she said, and rolled her eyes at her own inarticulate assessment.

Now Rowan bobbed closer, putting his hand on Paisley's stomach, holding her at her side, Paisley turning to her shoulder and kissing him. He lightly brushed his thumb from her chin to her ear, then down the long tendon of her fine neck, swooping down the center between her breasts and down her navel, touching her between her legs. She was slick, engorged—Paisley was

still horny. And he knew she was horny for Grady. Fireworks of unexpected taboo pleasure went off in the darkness of his frontal lobe, and under the water his stomach tightened hard enough to get his rock hard dick flexing and bobbing.

When their kiss broke, he looked in her eyes, said, “Let’s go up to the beach . . .”

PAISLEY

There was no way this would really happen, she'd thought. Had never wanted it in her life before. Had never thought of Grady like this. Well, at least not for years. Rowan was all she needed. But baking in the heat all day with these two gorgeous guys, feeling so good with them, so safe, so at peace . . . and then that abrupt arousal she'd felt when they first disrobed.

She had to admit something terrible: The arousal had been kicked off by seeing Grady naked.

Grady was a good-looking guy, there was no denying that, you knew that with his clothes on. But it was seeing him revealed that way on the beach that suddenly made him seem very sexual. And the carefree nature of the day had let all of this unfold to where now something would happen she couldn't believe would ever happen.

Large strong hands held each of hers, their feet finding the sand now, a large loving and caring man on either side of her, walking her up the beach, both of them belonging entirely to her for the afternoon. When the water was at their knees, they let their hands go, not sure what to do next. But Rowan guided her, putting his hand on her lower back, walking her up into the hot sand. He stopped to kiss her, and she let him, touching his arms and leaning back. Rowan reached for Grady, encouraging him to join.

Then Grady was there, all three of them close again, not under the water anymore, their naked bodies not hidden, now completely visible. She touched Rowan's chest, and he guided her hand, put it on Grady's chest. And Grady touched her back, his hand moving up her spine, getting her nipples even harder. Her legs began to tremble.

Rowan wanted her to touch Grady. Stood there supporting her, his hand massaging circles on her back, guiding her closer to his best friend. Both her hands went on to Grady now, and he touched her waist. She made swooping circles on his large muscular chest, down over the muscles of his ribs and stomach, back up to thumb at his nipples. He was built like Rowan, only a little bigger. A little taller. Both of them beautiful in their own way.

She wanted to kiss him, tilted her chin, and Grady held her neck now, and kissed her in return. His lips were soft and plump and wet, surprisingly cool since his skin was so hot. He was a good kisser, and she liked the way he held her neck and thumbed her jawline. Her breath came quicker; she rubbed his arms, rubbed his shoulders. Then stepping back, looking in his eyes, wanting Rowan now. Kissing Rowan.

All three of them together, her between two men—the two men facing each other, and her looking down their bodies to their masculine arousal. Both of them erect. And both of them different. In her right hand, she cupped Rowan's testicles, then slowly slid the curved webbing of her thumb and forefinger up the underside of his erection. Back down, cupping his testicles. Then looking up to Grady's eyes, wanting to hold his as well but timid.

Rowan stroked her arm and held her wrist, moved it between Grady's legs indicating it was all right to touch his penis. She looked to Rowan, knowing she had permission but asking with her eyes again, anyway. Rowan nodded. Then she sucked her lower lip, eager to explore what Grady had.

ROWAN

Paisley had only had sex with one guy in her life: Rowan. She'd made out with a couple other guys, said she'd given two hand jobs, but she went to an all-girl boarding school and stayed at home on the weekends under her mother's scrutiny. Once her mother had relaxed protocols, Paisley was already in love with him and he with her. So seeing her curious like this was wildly exciting—and safe because of the guy they'd included in their relationship.

Now he exchanged a look with Grady. A sheepish sort of embarrassment, both of them together in this strange sexual way, both of them disbelieving this was actually happening. They'd shared a lot together. Trials and tribulations, joy, grief, adolescence, adulthood, but never as something as profound as a girl they cared about . . .

Grady did something unexpected: reached out and gripped his upper arm. It reassured him—even though he hadn't expected wanting reassurance. He chuckled; Grady did too. Then Paisley followed.

But the ripple of awkward humor dissipated quickly, and Paisley returned to the task at hand. Her eyes went to Grady's eyes, her expression still holding the residual laugh, then down Grady's body (so damn close to hers) between his legs to his horse-like phallus. The laughing shape of her mouth shrank and her lips hung open, pouted, her face taking on a new and lusty look. God, it drove him wild that Paisley was aroused by this.

Slow—like she thought she might bail—her hand moved between Grady's thighs, where his huge cock hung. When her hand touched it, he groaned; his brain tumbled in its pan, and his knees jellied for a moment. To see his

beloved Paisley's hand on another man's arousal was astoundingly out-of-this-world sexual. That it was Grady's made it okay. That Grady's was so much larger than his own sent a frightening spike through him. But he liked it.

Paisley giggled girlishly and awkwardly feeling his size in her palm. Her hand ran down its dorsal side, fingers lightly tracing around the foreskin before she cupped it underneath and hefted it, testing its weight in her palm.

His eyes went from her hand cradling Grady's engorged manhood up to Paisley's face to read her reaction. It was deep lust. Grady aroused his girlfriend. His own cock throbbed, hard as a rock and pointing right at where his girlfriend's hand held another man, like it was eager for the same attention.

Then Paisley took Grady with both hands, being gentle and careful with his friend's over-sized cock, using just fingertips, caressing again, making light pleasure on their friend's most intimate and sensitive body part. She explored his foreskin—she must never have seen one before—her fingers squeezing his friend's squishy tissue bunched up around where his cock head would emerge; squeezing, teasing, plucking . . . then her other hand pulled gently rearward on his shaft and Paisley's eyes widened watching the skin go tight, roll inside out and Grady's huge healthy plump and glistening cock head emerge. Paisley let out a ghostly ohh sound of appreciation—and the sound of her sexual excitement this way drove him wild. He thrust his own cock out eagerly, not wanting to be excluded for too long.

GRADY

One of his favorite things was allowing a girl to get familiar with his size. All the girls he'd been with had never been with a guy as large as him, and there was something thrilling about that speculative moment when they first engaged with his cock, studied it, assessed it. They always liked it, even if they were intimidated. It had never not aroused a girl. And Paisley was the same. But seeing someone he really cared about being so turned on by his manhood was shaking him to his core. He had to remind himself Paisley belonged to Rowan and be respectful of his best friend. It took great effort not to take this amazing girl up in his arms and lay her out on the beach, drive himself up into her and make love, take her mouth while his cock probed deep in her core.

Paisley's touch had him trembling, testing his resolve, forced to stand now and accept her exploration rather than do the thing he wanted: put it inside her. Would Rowan even allow that?

To make matters worse, Paisley now took up Rowan's cock, and he feared she would compare them. He didn't want his friend intimidated by his girl being with a man whose equipment was larger. And Rowan wasn't small. Not at all. Paisley was not an unsatisfied woman. But she gripped both of their cocks similarly, holding them mid-shaft and upright, looking from his to Rowan's, gauging their size. And his was clearly larger. Paisley couldn't grip right around it, and he had to be two inches longer. He hoped it wouldn't upset Rowan to see them assessed this way.

Paisley began tugging on them both, jerking and squeezing, rotating her grip too; and the feel of her soft and careful hand had him hurting for the action to be accelerated. But if all this would be is touching and kissing, he

would ruin their friendship by taking control of Rowan's beautiful girlfriend and doing to her what he wanted.

Closer and closer, still stroking, Paisley angled their cocks so they were almost level, their tips almost touching. The size of their cock heads was being scrutinized now. He knew what she would be thinking. But Rowan didn't seem bothered at all. In fact his friend seemed to be fully engaged with his girlfriend's naughty manhood appraisal, his eyes turned down, and a hungry look on his face like a deep dirty part of him was actuated. If Rowan was into it, he was into it.

Hand on a hip now, he urged his pelvis forward, their cock heads touching. Paisley's stroke slowed, and she regarded him, then Rowan, then returned her gaze to the two cocks she held. Rowan hadn't flinched when their cocks touched, and Paisley liked the idea of them together, now letting them touch, Rowan pushing his hips forward, making their cocks line up side-by-side, Paisley holding them together, silky fingertips teasing and touching; the tip of his cock poked Rowan's pubic pad, displaying to Paisley their two-inch discrepancy in length. Both Paisley and Rowan were aroused seeing how much deeper he would go, and, oh good lord, if they wanted to play games like that, he would play them, because being with his two best friends, being included in their sexuality, was now doing more than affecting his body—his heart felt swelled with love and camaraderie and acceptance and inclusion.

PAISLEY

Rowan had a perfect cock, but there was something wildly alluring about Grady's. It was larger—large to the point of being huge with a capital H—smoother, thicker, and the head of it was plumper, shinier, and the fact that it could hide in its sleeve and then come out again put the strangest, sickest desire in her stomach. It was gross but she wanted it.

With both of their dicks in her hand, she tilted her face to Grady, wanting to taste his mouth again. While they kissed, Rowan bit on her shoulder and caressed her breasts. She let go their manhoods, touched Grady's hips, then smoothed palms on his hard stomach, feeling all the angled slabs of his flexing abs. His cock tapped her inner thigh and her knees went weak at the provoked thought this might go further, at the thought she might have him inside her. As she slumped, both her guys supported her, Grady putting hands at the small of her back and Rowan dipping his knees and encircling arms around her waist. Now they were tangled. Tangled and horny and hot and saltwater wet. But it felt incredible to be held and sandwiched by two gorgeous guys. She bit her lip while she smiled at each of them in turn, then said, "What do you guys want to do?"

Rowan looked to Grady, said, "I think we should make her come."

She snorted air through her nostrils, knees weakening further, their grip on her tightening. "You do?"

"Paisley loves to come," he said.

Grady said, "Who doesn't?"

Rowan gripped Grady's wrist and unlocked his friend's hands from behind her back, guiding Grady to touch her between her legs. She let out another embarrassing moan in anticipation. But then Grady's large hand was between her legs, his bound fingers pushing into the scratchy gap between her thighs and his palm then sliding over her slickness. God, she thought she'd dampened, but now it was proven: Grady's hand went over her sex like it had been oiled.

The feel of her readiness provoked a low rumbling sound in Grady's chest, and he immediately took her mouth with another kiss. She ran her tongue into his mouth. Their mouths wrestled while he humped the heel of his hand into her aching clit, but then it was too much—Grady broke their kiss, his hungry eyes on hers. "Let's get on land," he said, and before she could say yes, he'd put his arms around her, hugged her, caressed her, then squatted and lifted her.

Her legs went around him, and he cupped her bare ass. She looked for Rowan but couldn't find him, whispered in Grady's ear, "Where's Rowan?"

Grady strode with her through the knee-deep water, up to the beach, turning at the waist so she could see where they were headed, and see that Rowan was leading the way. He hefted her higher, and she squirmed over his muscular shoulder, looking down the moving humps of his muscular back and watching his ass cheeks move as he walked. She patted his arm saying, "Wait, not the beach, I don't want to be in the sand . . ."

ROWAN

He set the stage for them, getting up the white sand beach and to the spot where they'd first rested after swimming from the fishing boat. He gathered up all their clothes to give them space, shoving all the items under an arm, hiking further up the rock, dick bouncing and aching, dumping their things where they'd stay safe and dry, turned then to see Grady holding Paisley, Paisley clinging to his friend's body.

Why on earth was this so arousing?

No time to ponder and ruin it, he dashed carefully down the slanted rough rock to join them as Grady set Paisley's feet in the sand and her sun-pink bottom on the rock, getting over her, mouth on hers, hands on the rock on either side of her thighs. Paisley kissed him with both hands on his face.

Grady kissed her till she was flat on the rock, opening her legs for him. Grady put his weight on one arm and let his hand stroke up Paisley's inner thigh, making her sing a funny note into his mouth. Rowan set himself next to them, getting close and kissing her shoulder. She felt it, broke from Grady's kiss and gave him her mouth. He cupped her neck and kissed her, and she gasped. They both looked down to see Grady sliding two fingers inside her. Paisley bit her lower lip and held it clenched; brought her knees higher, walking her heels up the rock, her toes flexed up. He sat and kissed her knee, took a close look at what it looked like in bright sunshine when his best friend cupped his two big middle fingers in and out of his girl. His cock absolutely ached at the sight.

Grady said, "She's so wet . . ."

Paisley went up on her elbows, watching them, sighing, “I know-I know . . . oh, God, that feels so, so good.” Her eyes fluttered; her head rocked back.

He bit her knee again, then stroked a palm up her inner thigh, making her sing that warbling note of pleasure once more. Grady fingered her fast, then slow, playing her pussy like an instrument. He got her breaths coming in heavy chuffs, working her to a frenzy then fading back, making Paisley moan for her release.

That they could deliver her this pleasure felt powerful and wonderful and happy—three people alone on the most beautiful part of the planet for a few hours. He couldn’t resist her mouth anymore, lunging to take her kiss, Paisley putting her arms out to hold him. They made out, him to the side, her with her legs open while Grady fingered her.

Grady got her bucking and writhing, her arms flexing against Rowan, twisting against him. Her mouth pulled back, Paisley looking away, eyes closed, teeth bared. Her nipples were like bolts on her breasts. “Ah, ah, ah,” she began to chant and his stomach tightened. He was about to witness another man make his girlfriend come . . .

GRADY

Paisley's gorgeous little pussy went to liquid around his fingers when she came. There had never been a more beautiful woman he'd ever seen than Paisley in that moment her face contorted as he made her orgasm. And when it was done, and she'd been left gasping, he felt his own liquid thrill: a sudden surge deep in his core. His cock drooled a zip-line of silvery excitement that dribbled Paisley's inner thigh and ran toward where his fingers still plunged into her. The sight of his own sexual lubricant on her skin and heading to her vagina got him lightheaded—and it only made him propel more down her leg.

Rowan eased back, his friend's eyes gone glassy with lust at the sight of another man with his fingers inside his girlfriend, looking lower at Grady's cock where it spewed his pre-come down Paisley's leg. And Rowan's lusty look deepened.

"Oh God, Paisley," Grady groaned, and collapsed over her body, his elbows against the rock on either side of her waist. He kissed her chest, plucked at her nipples with lip-protected teeth. She raked her fingers through his hair, body still rolling under the pleasure of the orgasm he delivered.

Their bodies writhed against one another, hot and sweaty and hard; his cock throbbed with desire; his balls ached for release. His hips humped against her with a mind of their own as they kissed and he sucked her nipples. And Paisley rolled with him, showing her own desire to fuck. He was overcome with passion for this girl. He was rocked by a powerful freight train of driving need to mate with her; a grinding twelve gear transmission of hot and hard desire for his best friend's girl—the one he fell for first. The one that could have been his . . .

ROWAN

Grady handled Paisley tentatively at first, hands moving on her body cautiously, but the more they kissed, the more Grady's restraint was abandoned. Both of them breathed heavily. Grady gripped her, grabbed her, held her breasts, squeezing them at times. Kissed her nipples, her neck, both of them humping their bodies against each other. And the more engaged Grady was, the more Grady drew the same response from Paisley.

At first she was timid as well, only touching Grady softly. But as their mouths wrestled, their tongues in each other's mouths, he watched Paisley's hands clinch Grady's upper arms, her fingertips and nails pressing into his huge triceps. Then stroking his arms, swooping around his back, slipping under his arms, down his sides, grabbing his ass.

Soon it was like they were making love. Only, Grady's erection lay on Paisley's stomach. But they were engaged sexually. They were mashing their sexes together. The wide boat hull of Grady's huge cock grinding against Paisley's engorged membranes. It made slick wet sounds. And in brief glimpses as they rolled together, he could see how wet Paisley was. From coming, for sure, but also in anticipation . . .

But were they ready for that? It certainly seemed that way. Would Grady put it in her? Would Paisley do it herself?

His heart pounded and his cock throbbed watching his two favorite people on earth sharing with one another, giving each other pleasure and engaging in sweet but sexual congress. Grady's humping became more urgent, driving the base of his cock to flatten Paisley's labia. And each time he did, Paisley cried out.

One time he thought she might have come, because her legs shook, and she dug her nails deep into the tight muscles at Grady's sides.

Paisley's legs lifted, but when her knees came up, she knew it was an invitation for Grady to penetrate her, and she refused it, grunting while they kissed, then laying her legs flat again. But the whole while, the two of them never stopped writhing and embracing and kissing.

Was he going to leave it up to Paisley? She wouldn't do that. Wouldn't accept Grady into her body. Not without asking. Fingers were one thing, not his cock.

So he inched closer, pushing away all the frantic valuation twisting his thoughts, squashing it. Knowing only in his heart that this thing that was happening before his eyes was what he wanted. If they were holding back because of him . . .

Rowan's body touched Paisley's, and she turned her face. He kissed her. Grady bit at her neck. She whimpered like she was going to lose her mind. He kissed her mouth, pressed his face between her and Grady to suck on her nipple. Then went up to sit on a hip, one hand flat on the rock.

Grady and Paisley resumed their kissing, and he smiled, then put his hand between their bodies. Feeling his hand made them both flinch. Grady sucked his stomach in tight, and Paisley's eyes snapped open. Nothing was said, but he rested his hand over top of Grady's cock where it lay on Paisley's stomach, up past her navel. They shared a momentary look between each other, eyes flicking to eyes.

He pushed back on Grady's cock, Grady allowing it, raising his rump, shifting further down Paisley's body. She caressed Grady's arms and looked at Rowan with puzzlement and worry. Then Rowan eased back Grady's foreskin, guided the plump end of his friend's cock into the hot slippery pink nest of his girlfriend's opening . . .

PAISLEY

Though she couldn't believe Rowan would allow this at all, she wanted it so bad there was no way she would object. They would deal with it later.

She looked in Grady's eyes, and he looked in hers. She touched his cheek. Then looked between their bodies.

Grady had reared his hips back, and Rowan held Grady's huge penis. Rowan pulled the foreskin back and was now teasing at her with the exposed plump end of Grady's cock. She squeezed her stomach tight in anticipation, and could feel a spate of preparatory cum. Her own body lubricating itself eagerly for her lover's entry.

Rowan saw how wet she was and bit his lower lip. He looked at her, then back down to where he held his friend's penis at her entry. He pressed down on Grady's glans with his thumb, pushing it into her opening. She tilted her pelvis upward to meet it, and Grady pushed forward. She made a gentle hiss, caressed Grady's neck, saying, "Be careful . . ."

And Grady was. Rowan moved out of the way now, Grady's cock fixed in place and sliding into her body. She raised her knees, brought them up Grady's sides to allow him less restricted access.

Her labia flexed aside as his tremendous girth widened her, the larger size demanding her softness to yield to another man's unfamiliar passage. It felt much like scorching at first, a high thin feeling of pain like she would tear, but blood rushed and raced her membranes suddenly, washing all the tightness away and leaving throbbing pleasure.

"Oh god, it's huge, oh, oh wow . . ."

She'd never been with anyone except Rowan. Rowan was her everything. Had never wanted another man. But if offered Grady, she wouldn't refuse. Grady was special, and she knew it. This would be the three of them today, sharing and enjoying, three twenty-one-year-olds far from home, somewhere exotic. It was meant to be.

“Oh Grady, god, you're so fucking big . . .”

Slowly, Grady pushed himself in, then pulled out, being careful, then taking her mouth and touching her face gingerly. Her forehead burned with red heat, her body firing up strange reactions to accommodate an unexpected larger man. But loving it. Her body figuring out how to find pleasure from mating with him. She opened her legs, closed them. Squeezed her knees to his ribs. Raised her knees to Grady's shoulders, let him get deeper. The new depth Grady touched exploded a wash of foreign brain chemicals that flooded her with insane pleasure. But it was too much, too deep, too fast, and she pressed down on his hips with the curled soles of her feet. Grady was considerate, responsive. Letting her guide the lovemaking, even though he was on top and in control, she had final say.

GRADY

It took everything he had not to drive himself deep inside Paisley and claim her as his own. If there was no Rowan in her life, he would have her hands up above her head, their fingers interlocked, their mouths intertwining while his hips thundered what he had in and out of her body, driving her wild. But he was slow and careful, letting Paisley tell him what she wanted. But the slowness was spinning him like a top. Allowing his mind time to compensate emotion with action. Thinking out too much about how this felt. Not just how tight and amazing she was, not just recognizing how wet she got for him, not about the passion in her kiss, or the scratching diamonds of her nipples against his hard chest. It was his heart and his mind. It was the flooding swell of emotions that had him squinting not to show it. His heart burst in his chest, swelling twice its size.

He grunted, collapsed on her, hugged her tight. Put his arms right around her so her back was off the rocks. She scratched her nails down his back. He drove deeper. Thought about what could have been. Thought about the mistakes he made. But he wasn't that same guy anymore, and this wasn't meant to be. When he'd set her up with Rowan, he'd done the best thing he ever could for her. So he would take this as a moment in time gifted, something delivered to him that he didn't even deserve. But once that rolling ball of emotion began, it was unstoppable. He already felt his stomach tightening, his cock hard inside her, being careful not to hurt her with it, letting her adjust, but again the slowness making it unbearable . . . He grunted, flexed his arms, drove a little deeper. Paisley cried out, stroked his shoulders and arms, feeling his muscle, liking it. And before he knew it, the floodgates had clanged open . . .

PAISLEY

Grady was an incredible lover. But that wasn't surprising. Not surprising at all, but before she abandoned herself to him, she thrust her head back, looking up at the cloudless azure sky. Like she was coming to the surface after swimming too deep. Her hand thrashed out, seeking Rowan. Finding him, nails grabbing his forearm, his warm hand clasping her forearm, too. She pulled him, her nails digging in, scratching like she was holding on for dear life, caught on the cliff edge between reality and abandon. But not wanting to lose herself to Grady, only wanting the three of them together. She looked at Rowan urgently, and he knew what she wanted, throwing himself over her, putting his mouth on hers.

Now Grady pushed in and out, so large and stretching, the pleasure intense, and she took Rowan's tongue, and clumsily scratched at his neck. He handled her breasts, flicked at her nipples, the whole while Grady continuing, up now on his powerful arms, hands on either side of her waist.

She waved her hand around until she found Rowan's erection, gripped it and stroked, found it pulsing pre-come. He groaned into her mouth, and her heart pounded and swelled. Being with two men was astounding. And she wouldn't leave Rowan behind.

As she thundered toward her third orgasm, she felt herself go slick inside. Knew it was Grady. Knew he must be close, could feel his size swelling larger inside her.

Now she looked to him, Rowan kissing her neck, Grady's handsome face twisted in what looked like frustration. Sweat coursed his handsome features, and a long comber of chestnut hair bounced on his brow. The

muscles of his shoulders bulged and gleamed, and the veins had risen like cables from his biceps into a web work along his powerful forearms.

“Shit, shit, shit,” he cursed—“Shit,” finally saying, thrusting his hips back, pulling his huge cock out and tossing its heavy weight onto her stomach, leaving her pussy feeling gored. Cooler air touched at her core; he’d left her gaping. She squeezed her thighs against his waist. And then he was coming. Humping his cock into her stomach, his balls flattening and screwing against her pussy, warming it again. His semen burst from him with surprising force, landing between her and Rowan, tugging on her hair, darting out in long pearly ribbons that scattered hot dashes on her chest and collar. Grady growled the whole while, stabbing his hips forward and crushing his balls against her pussy—a feeling that drove her wild. Endless semen still squirted from him; onto her breasts and pooling in the divots of her ribs and stomach. It was lewd, but outrageously hot to share that with him (and to share it with Rowan).

She let out a satisfied groan, wanting Grady to know the effect it had on her, touching Rowan’s cheek now and scratching his neck, gyrating her pussy against the base of Grady’s cock. Grady hid his face against the globe of his shoulder muscle, hair bouncing, and she touched his face now, too, stroking his cheek. She’d never felt more sexually powerful in her whole life.

GRADY

He groaned again and bit at his bicep in frustration. Embarrassed. Practically a two-pump chump. Not quite, but a few minutes wasn't impressive. He groaned once more, an embarrassed sound that he hated, chanced a look . . . Paisley was kissing Rowan.

He sighed, said, "Sorry . . ."

His friends broke their kiss, Paisley looked at him.

He said, "I haven't been with anyone in a long time."

Paisley looked puzzled, then said, "That was insanely hot, you—"

He said, "Like a year. I haven't been with anybody in a year . . ."

Paisley looked at him honestly, touched his arm. "It was incredible . . ."

But then Rowan was hungry for her. And how could he not be? Look at her. She was incredible. And Rowan had her, taking her mouth now with ease because he already owned her heart. Had it good and tight. Paisley loved Rowan endlessly.

As he watched them kiss, that feeling of exclusion fell over him again, like he was floating on shipwreck debris, his friends on a rowboat, the waves gradually separating them. And then shame. He fucked her. He fucked his best friend's girlfriend.

But Rowan had put your cock in her—he wouldn't have fucked Paisley without permission . . . but he had fucked her. He'd put himself in between

his best friend and his best friend's girlfriend.

Fucking dummy, he said to himself. You're such a fucking dummy. When will you ever learn?

The evidence of his shame spattered Paisley's chest. The pearly and disgusting archipelago he'd spewed on her beautiful body. His disgusting seed. Knew that he wouldn't come inside her. Took it out, came on her stomach. Only, it had been a long time he'd been with anybody. And it had been shot out with force that surprised him. But he would be a fool to think it was just the amount of time since his last fuck that got him so excited. It was his partner. It was Paisley.

And now, with his sexual evidence painted on her chest, he'd separated his best friend from his girlfriend. Rowan couldn't take her now. Rowan couldn't put his arm around her without being smeared by his disgusting friend's juice. He couldn't take her the way he wanted, he had to kiss her sideways.

How do you ruin everything?

PAISLEY

The heat of the sun kept Grady's semen from chilling on her skin. But despite it not growing cold, she was hyper-aware of Rowan's best friends ejaculate on her. And now she worried about her sweet man. Worried what Rowan would think. He put Grady inside her, but could he now blame her somehow? Put this on her? I was just teasing it, you guys did the rest—you let Grady go in your body, how could you do that to me . . .? Only, that wasn't Rowan at all. Rowan wasn't that kind of guy. That was her other friends' boyfriends. Hurling shit their way, blaming them, cheating on them. But she had the hottest guy with the biggest heart. They would get snippy at worst, never fought. Saw everything the same way . . . So she connected her eyes to his, scratching at his cheekbone, looking deep into her lover. No words said, searching only for shame or remorse or guilt or blame. Found none of it. It didn't take long to see that Rowan hurled no hate her way.

And it only lasted a moment, because now he was scrambling over top of her. Grady had risen to his knees between her open legs, holding onto his slick cock, and when Rowan hitched a leg over her, Grady backed up and stood on the sand and watched. And then Grady was forgotten.

Now it was Rowan. It was her and Rowan. And she thought for a moment she needed to remind him that she had another man's semen on her, but there wasn't time. Rowan gripped himself, pushed against her aperture and went inside her fully in one stroke. Now the familiar feel of her man's cock reamed in and out of her. And where Grady was deliberate, and careful, Rowan knew her, knew how she liked it. And he drove hard. Sometimes she liked it hard. And Rowan knew how to do it. Knew the angles, the pace; knew what she wanted.

Rowan got her hitching in breath tighter and tighter until her lungs expanded her ribs against her skin. She came. Came from her lover, thinking only of him. Thinking how he felt. Knowing she was being reclaimed. Reclaimed by the one she loved. She let him know exactly how amazing he was. Theatrical maybe, but she cried and thrashed underneath Rowan, scratching at his back first, and when he reared up, she ran her nails down his chest. She squeezed the muscles of his arms, encouraging him to give it to her. She came again.

Rowan grunted, “Did he fuck you good?”

“What?” she asked, bewildered, unsure how to answer.

“Tell me he fucked you good—tell me you loved it . . .”

Whatever he wanted. She clasped his cheeks, looked in his wild eyes. “He fucked me so good, Rowan, he—”

“He fucked you deep?”

“So deep, baby, he touched my spleen, baby . . .”

And it drove Rowan wilder.

“He fucked me so good and deep,” she whispered, caressing him, “he fucked me so good with his huge cock . . .”

Then Rowan was roaring, and she scratched his arms, dug her nails into him. Looked into his eyes and through clenched teeth demanded: “I need your come, baby, I need it—come inside me . . .”

Perfect words. Because Rowan bared his teeth now, too, the both of them snarling at each other like passionate animals and Rowan came. He came and stabbed, came and roared, stabbed and collapsed.

ROWAN

When he heaved his heavy body off of Paisley, he'd never felt more spent. So much was drained from him. Not just physically or sexually—but emotionally. Spiritually. The act of sharing someone he loved so much with someone else he loved so much put a grip on his thundering heart muscle. But not a tight one, a caressing one, slick and oily and caring.

But the dirty talk had spilled over, and he worried how it would be perceived now in the aftermath. When it was happening, his need to hear her say those dirty things pulled on him and it was like he was holding the reins of a horse. It was impossible not to utter them.

He rested on an elbow at Paisley's side. His breath scored in and out, chest rising and falling in heavy bellowing. And Paisley still writhed as if there were a phantom man making love to her. It was too much to bear, the sight of her this way, so sexual, racing the lust through his heart like jet fuel. And Grady watched her too, eyes wide and marveling. Grady knew Paisley, but not this way. Grady was seeing her in an all new way, probably not knowing Rowan'd never seen her supercharged this way either.

Paisley pumped her hips, her ass muscles flexing where they were squashed on the rock. Her hands stroked over the slick sweat of her midsection, fingertips scoring down to the V crease where her thighs met her pelvis. Her eyes were closed, her mouth open and panting. Like she fantasized there was still one of them inside her. Sweat glistened on her skin, tracing zipping white long the raised ridges of her beautiful body. Watching Paisley like this was too much for Grady to bear . . .

Now Grady was getting over top of her again, giving her his mouth. Paisley was eager to respond, hands stroking his sides, their lips smacking together, her hand coming to cup his large hanging testicles. His cock lay on the underside of her forearm, almost in the crease of her elbow. She squeezed his balls, then slipped the cup of her palm up and down the belly of his cock, mewling into their kiss a sound of appreciation. Grady was hard again. Hard, and Paisley wanted it inside her.

Paisley angled him to enter her again, lifting her knees. Rowan watched Grady's foreskin retract, the plump end part Paisley's shining membranes, then push inside her body. Paisley made a high pained sound, then a low catlike groaning, embracing Grady's large muscular body and kissing him deeper.

Grady pushed deep inside Paisley's body, and her head went back, her chin thrust to the sky. When she tucked her chin to her chest again, she held the back of Grady's head, looking in his eyes. Looking in Grady's eyes but speaking to Rowan: "I want him to come inside me . . ."

Grady's mouth hung open with desire.

Paisley asked again: "Rowan, I want him to come inside me . . ."

"Do it," he said, and Paisley bit her lip.

Grady bore his gaze into Paisley's, both of them connecting deep, and then he was thrusting in and out of her, getting Paisley to cry out crazy lustful sounds.

She panted: "Yeah—you're going to?"

Grady growled and fucked her harder.

But then Paisley was pushing back Grady's hips with her hands, Grady taking her too deep, and when they looked in each other's eyes again, they were quiet for a heartbeat before Paisley said, "I want to be on top . . ."

GRADY

He unsheathed his hardness from Paisley's tight insides, looking at her bewildered for a moment, not believing that the exciting thing they had done would continue now.

"Yeah?" he said, but not waiting for an answer, turning to sit at her side, pulling on her wrist to guide her up. She stood in the sand, got between his legs, eyeing his erection—shining with her juices—then putting knees on his thighs and climbing into his lap. He leaned back to accommodate her, his hands slipping up and down her sweaty and slender body. Then she was squatting, reaching behind her, taking the base of his cock and angling it, stroking up then using her fingers to push it into her body.

He thumbed the head of his cock from the front side, making her hiss as his large cock head pierced her tight ring. But once it was in, she was moaning and sliding down his shaft, her knees squeezing the sides of his hips. He cupped her bottom to support her, let her take from his hardness what she needed. She rode him, and they kissed. And it was too good to be true. Heart bursting in his chest, not deserving this moment, but squeezing from it everything he could . . .

ROWAN

It was incredible to watch, and he slipped off the rock, moved between Grady's opened knees and tidied Paisley's hair so it hung on her back. She rolled her hips with Grady inside her, and Rowan slipped his hands down her front side, kissed her forehead from above and thumbed at her aching nipples. It drove Paisley wild, and soon she was coming again.

They were doing what they set out to do. Make Paisley come. He'd lost count how many times his girlfriend had been made to come this afternoon.

His hand went down her belly, the palm touching below her navel, knowing his friend's cock was just under the surface, deep in her body, spreading her wide and giving her amazing pleasure that he wanted her to have. He fingered her clit, mashing and rolling while she fucked Grady, did it until she cried out again, blacking for a moment and collapsing against Grady.

Rowan smiled, withdrew his arm from between their bodies and let Grady embrace her. As she came-to, she began to shimmy her hips again—awkward at first, then more eager. He stepped back now, set his butt in the hot soft sand and watched how his friend's cock spread his girl. The width of Grady's manhood stretching her pink ring thin and bright, shining with wet. Noted how Paisley just wanted Grady deep. Not thrusting, but in good and snug so she could dance on him. Her hips rolled circles, making her pussy squelch; she would go slow and then get really fast so that she was crying out in quick yelps. And then she would come. It went on and on, and he loved that Paisley was delivered such ecstasy. His cock returned to full throbbing hardness, and he waited for his turn . . .

GRADY

He warned her: “I’m gonna come, Paisley.”

She squeaked a Yes. It tickled at his heart like a feather.

He asked: “Yeah?”

“Uh-huh,” she squeaked again, and humped her hips on him faster. If there was any doubt, it was gone now, Paisley wanted him to come inside her. So he gripped her hips, held her steady, and pounded up into her, fast and hard, chasing it down. His balls bounced and slapped between his legs, sticking to his thighs, pulling free, and something about knowing that his friend Rowan was watching him do this to his girl was going to make this orgasm too big to contain.

He cried out half of Paisley’s name when it ripped through him. Loud, growling “Pais—” Choked off, he clutched her tight. It forced the air from her lungs and she ravaged his back with her nails, feeling him ejaculating inside her. He bit her collarbone, bit her neck, gripped her shoulder and neck tight, and held her in place, forcing himself deeper. She cried out, raked nails on his arms, gave a sound of pain. But instead of kneeing herself up to relieve the pressure of his size going too far into her, she tightened her stomach and forced herself to sit hard, accepting him. His cock throbbed and pulsed, hot jets of come filling up her pussy.

They breathed against each other, their flat stomachs bellowed outward and sealed together by heat and sweat. Her pussy trembled, quivered against him, the muscles undulating up and down and milking him. His cock still

pulsed, flexed, and he could feel the tickle of his ejaculate still spewing. It kept coming.

And then Paisley was rising, and he let his hands off of her, worried he'd done something wrong—but seeing it was Rowan helping her off.

Paisley was shaky, enervated and out of it, looking over her shoulder with dazed eyes, meeting Rowan's gaze, letting him do what he wanted. She had trouble standing, and Rowan guided her forward, used his knees to spread her legs wider. Paisley fell over top of him, her breasts hanging, and he gripped them, kissed her mouth, as Rowan took her from behind.

ROWAN

Grady's semen leaked a pearly slug that dribbled from Paisley's gaping petals and tangled in her pubic patch. He thumbed her tiny little knot of a butthole and pushed his cock into her pussy using his best friend's seed as lubrication. She took him easily. She'd been worn and stretched, her insides were a warm and welcoming oven. She responded immediately, tightening on him, making sounds of pleasure, blurring it against Grady's lips as they kissed.

"Yes," she hissed, "yes . . ."

And he stood behind his girlfriend standing over Grady with her legs open, claiming her pussy from behind while she made out with his best friend. Grady cuddled her breasts, and sometimes he could feel Grady's hand against the sides of his cock, Grady pleasuring at Paisley's clit. She came again, and when she couldn't stand anymore, her knees buckled and she fell against Grady. Grady braced her, held her steady so Rowan could finish inside her.

When he pulled out this time, he fell against the rock next to them hard enough to bang and scrape his hip. Paisley curled against Brady's muscular chest, eyes closed and sleepy, and Grady embraced her. The sun was high above, arcing now over the cliff and beginning to cast pools of shadow around their feet at the base of the rock where they'd engaged in wild three-way fornication. He chuckled, still unable to catch his breath, and he slowly drifted off watching Grady beginning to doze, creeping ever so slowly back until he lay on the rock with Paisley sleeping against his body.

PAISLEY

When she woke, her skin stung. She sat up and felt the salt from sweat, seawater, (and semen) crinkle and flake on her skin. Rowan lay next to her, knees touching her thigh, waking as well because he'd sensed her moving. Grady lay half a foot away on her other side, one knee up, forearm over his sleeping face. He was the kind of guy who took sun well, and his muscular torso gleamed. But that sleeping over-sized creature laying on his leg looked a little too pink for her liking. She resisted the urge to flip it over because it was best that what they'd done together stay behind them now that it over. So she rolled aside to face sleepy Rowan and kissed his forehead, stroked his face, and said they should get dressed before they burned. He kissed her mouth but avoided her eyes and she couldn't tell if he was just drowsy or if he felt shame. The last thing she felt like she wanted to do now was pursue it here in front of Grady, all three of them still naked.

She roused Grady now, being mindful to avoid touching his body in its intimate places. Instead she rocked his shoulder and whispered, "You're going to burn, Grady." Rowan hugged himself to her back and his lips pressed and held a pucker on her shoulder. Grady woke, looked their way, a lazy smile tugging to one side. Then it was as if he remembered what they'd all done and also recognized the moment was gone. He covered his cock with a hand, held it, sat up and raked fingers back and forth through his hair.

Rowan helped them all by giving them a task: "I'm starving—let's go up and find the fishing village."

Good old Rowan got them on the tracks, getting Grady to smile again. Grady let go his cock (but she saw it drop down below his bent legs and rest

on the rock), and he put elbows on knees, rubbing his cheeks and looking out at the sea where a white cruise ship passed left to right far on the horizon.

Without saying anything else, they rose, and Rowan headed up the rock to retrieve their clothing. She looked to the sea and thought of running in and rinsing off, but then she'd be wet. She was already dry, disinfected by sun, the sweat and semen turned to dust. So she rubbed her arms and legs, shoulders and her chest, making a fine dust. Rowan returned with their things and they all dressed, giving each other privacy for the moment. But it was her and Rowan who were a couple, and as soon as they were clothed again Rowan couldn't keep his hands off her. He hugged her and made happy groaning sounds that chased away any doubts she may have about having a threesome with her boyfriend and his buddy.

Grady, though, was strangely quiet, making him seem distant. The urge to enjoin him came, but she was unsure how to handle it, worried any affection sent Grady's way could hurt Rowan in the aftermath. But something told her Rowan would be okay and she held out a hand for Grady, giving him an expression that showed affection. He nodded once, quirking his mouth to the side in a display of discomfort, and she said, "I'm going to need some help up the rocks." Which was true. They'd both fucked her twice. Rowan wasn't small, and he'd gone hard, and while Grady'd been more gentle, he was so much larger. She'd only stood a moment while getting dressed, and could feel a weakness trembling in her thighs, and also worried about taking long strides to climb the rock faces. She didn't hurt yet between her legs, but it would be coming soon.

The future discomfort would be worth the events of the day. Hands down the greatest and most intense sexual experience of her entire life. Even more than when Rowan had claimed her virginity. Virginity was every girl's rite of passage, but how many in the number of women that existed could claim they'd had sex with two gorgeous guys that they cared for and who cared for her? And who'd fucked her the way Rowan and Grady did. As much as the three of them needed to leave here and go and eat and get on with their trip, she couldn't deny that staying for another round wasn't out of the

question. A sexual hunger still simmered inside her; it could be brought to boil very fast.

Rowan was eager to get going. He always wanted to eat after he came—especially carbs—and she smiled at him, hearing his stomach grumble. All chances of more lovemaking thinned as Rowan led the way up the rock where they'd had sex, turning to take her hand. Her legs were weak and wobbly, and she wouldn't trust them to support herself in precarious climbing (like if they were going up to the diving cliff), but Grady stayed behind her and sometimes he would rest a hand on her back to steady her or even hold her waist if she had to stretch a leg out to cross a gap. It was slow work and careful, and they didn't say much, but in about ten minutes Rowan was hoisting her up to flat land at the top of the cove's sloping rock walls.

ROWAN

No fishing village to be seen, just a vast irregular and rocky field of grass and balding patches of sunbaked earth. In the distance they could make out strokes of woods and what looked like might be a rock wall. That's where they headed.

The rock wall was the perimeter around crumbling remains of ancient ruins; a faceless limestone fortress being reclaimed by overcrowding garrigue. Along the far side of the fortress there was a rough and rocky gravel path. They walked for fifteen minutes on the path until they were met by a group of people their same age headed to the fortress—Germans, who said in broken English there was a hostel if they just followed the trail from where the Germans had come.

They walked a beaten trail over a grassy sun-bleached hill and found themselves at a compound of block buildings, concrete painted in ochre. It had the look of four-story apartments, but it was right on a swath of high rocky coast, and the Mediterranean spread out beyond. A patio ran the side, and they assumed around behind as well, and it was dotted with lots of people moving in and out. A sign posted as they got closer told them it was a Nature Preserve. There'd be food inside, they were sure of it, and they all looked to each other hopefully.

Inside there was a cafeteria that opened out to the patio and they paid fifteen Euros for all three of them and had coffee and bowls of egg salad mixed with canned tuna and green beans, eating on the sunny porch looking out over the sea and chatting with some Brits. There was a tour group of Chinese kids passing the patio's railing, all between ten and fourteen, visiting for the nature preserve, and it was funny to think of the secluded

and sexual day the three of them had today only about a twenty-five minute hike from this very spot. Could someone from the nature preserve have been out walking, hidden, and spied on them? Too late now. Too late now, and they were leaving Malta tomorrow afternoon, anyway . . .

What they'd done was crazy, and as they ate and found anything to talk about except the fact they'd all had sex together, he watched Paisley's face. There was color in her cheeks and a shine in her eyes that betrayed her new and uncomfortable exterior since the act. Deep down he knew she'd enjoyed it and that they'd all be okay. There was some strange ground they walked on, but once they were sure-footed they'd find their stride again. He reached to Paisley, thumbed away a crumb of feta from the plump and luscious curl of her perfect lips, and she kissed his thumb. Their eyes met, and in that quick moment he saw they were already coming to the surface.

PAISLEY

Grady arranged with some Swiss who were living in Malta for one of their gang to give them a drive from the preserve into Marsaxlokk. Grady had a charming way about him and while they negotiated a fee in good-natured terms, the Swiss had only been joking and the guy didn't take their money once he'd dropped them outside an open-air port-side market in the city of Marsaxlokk.

Rowan got out ahead of her, holding the door and offering his hand. Grady had sat up front, and now said bye to their driver, all of them waving as he drove off in his tiny Peugeot hatchback. They came together and crossed the flagstone of the open air market at the harbor's edge. Boats passed along in the water, and the market was lively.

"I'm still hungry," she said to Rowan, and he was instantly on her, arm around her, waving Grady closer. Grady seemed distant since they'd woken after sex, and she hoped he'd loosen up as time went on.

Rowan said they should get something more to eat before they got on the bus back to Valetta, and Grady agreed. The guys wanted pitas from one of the stalls, but she went out to the curbside where the market met the road and lined up at an ice cream truck. Boy, now it was her with a sweet tooth after sex. She'd pondered Rowan's after-sex eating, when he'd leave her in bed and go eat an apple or sometimes just a spoonful of sugar, thinking how it must have biological urge behind it, like his body needed to replenish the sperm he'd used. What was it with her now? She was the opposite of depleted. They'd put their loads inside of her. Three of them. One of them on her chest and stomach. A huge load. And, damn, if it wasn't the hottest thing ever. Even now, waiting in the sun to place her order, the heavy sexual

feeling she'd got when skinny-dipping with them returned. But as she looked back she was disheartened to see Rowan and his best friend separated, not standing together, but off getting condiments for their own food orders. Would their afternoon ruin Rowan's relationship with Grady? She sure hoped not. More time would be needed, she hoped, that was all.

GRADY

Any chance he thought he might have getting past the thing they'd done was dashed watching the hottest girl he'd ever known walking their way eating an ice cream cone. He was glad to see her coming. It was awkward between him and Rowan without her there. But seeing her long legs shining—tanned and perfect, strutting their way—his heart broke knowing Paisley didn't belong to him. He wanted her more now that he had a taste of her. But what an awful feeling to have over your best friend's girl. He never should have agreed to meet them in Malta. No—that wasn't true. If he hadn't come, he wouldn't have shared Paisley the way he did. But maybe it was better to not have ever tasted her at all if you weren't allowed to savor. It only showed him how much she had to offer. And every minute since she'd fallen asleep in his arms after they'd mated a second time, she was moving further and further from him.

It was terrible, but now all he had to look forward to was getting out of Malta and moving on to Greece tomorrow. Get this girl out of his system. Leave her to her man, his best friend.

Rowan and Grady stood about a half-dozen feet apart, each of them eating their own sandwich, when Paisley rejoined them. Rowan put his arm around Paisley again. Seeing Rowan do that easy act made him ache that it wasn't him who was able to do that as well. Rowan eyed her ice cream saying, "Who's got a sweet tooth?"

"It's so hot today—I don't even know how you guys want a hot sandwich."

He said, "Ice cream does look pretty good."

Paisley held the cone toward him. Just the sight of the ridges and flat spots her perfect tongue had put on the vanilla ice cream got him aroused again. But he begged off saying, “Doesn’t go with chicken pita,” holding up his almost finished wrap.

Then Rowan plucked from her ice cream cone a rolled chocolate Pirouette and bit it off. Paisley showed him a shocked and hurt face, saying, “You didn’t even ask . . .”

Seeing them playful made him jealous, and he hated the feeling.

Now Rowan waved what remained of the Pirouette around like a magic wand, then aimed it near Paisley’s face. Paisley opened her mouth to take a bite, and Rowan dabbed the tip of her nose. She stepped back, wiped at her nose with the back of her hand, and the whole theater of it made his heart ache harder.

“You’re such a jerk,” Paisley said to Rowan, and held out her ice cream cone to his Pirouette like they would sword fight. His two friends figuring out their relationship together in the aftermath quite well.

He took the last bite of his pita, chewed, watching them, grumbling to himself, then said: “Hey, when we get back, we should call those Maltese guys and see if they want to go out with us tonight . . .”

ROWAN

On the bus ride from Marsaxlokk to Valletta, he got another erection. It was him sitting with Paisley, and across the aisle, Grady sitting by himself. They were on the very last row of the almost empty bus. And when they got on, he considered giving up his spot with Paisley to Grady. There'd been a certain return of Grady's aloofness. It was awkward at the hostel, and then it was back to regular uncaring Grady when they were eating in Marsaxlokk. Then he's making plans for them all to go out with some other people when maybe they could have spent time together, the three of them alone . . .

He'd hoped their tryst on the beach together would bring them closer. But now it seemed things were returning to normal. There was a secret part of him that had hoped they would go back to their apartment, bypass going out with the Brits and the Maltese tonight, and instead hang around at the apartment and see what might happen. But Grady was over it already. And that hurt in its own small way. If they offered Grady this chance, why wouldn't he take it? Yeah, he took it, but he didn't want it anymore?

He needed time alone with Paisley to find out what she thought. Was she over it as well?

Paisley fell asleep at the back of the bus first. Inch by inch, beginning to sag against him, his arm around her. Grady sat across, the distance enough that they didn't talk. Grady looking out the window, anyway. And while his eyes grew heavy, enjoying the feel of Paisley next to him, he began to fantasize what it would be like if he'd given up his seat to Grady. What if he was sitting right now where Grady was, looking back in this spot, seeing Paisley with Grady instead of him? And that's how the erection happened. Imagining them beginning to kiss. Paisley's mouth going to his first,

maybe. Touching his chest. And his dick really got throbbing when he began to think of them getting into it. Their kisses deepening the way they did on the hot rock by the beach. Grady putting his hand down the front of Paisley's shorts and fingering her while she squeezed his cock through his shorts. And then more, taking it out of his shorts, looking to see if they were watched by anyone other than Rowan, stroking Grady's big cock (and she liked it, that was obvious), looking at it in her hand, then putting her mouth on it. Oh shit—putting her mouth on it . . .

The thought of him sitting where Grady was now, looking back and seeing his sweet Paisley's head bobbing up and down in Grady's lap until Grady came in her mouth brought him to full throbbing iron, swaying side-to-side in the back of the big bus.

GRADY

When they got back to the apartment, Paisley went into the shower. Rowan hung for a minute in the kitchen and they drank two glasses of water. But Rowan didn't mention how he'd fucked his girlfriend. Though it was a relief Rowan wasn't mad.

He didn't bring it up because he didn't feel like talking about it. If he talked about it, the worry was it would be over. Rowan would express regret, maybe say something negative about the experience. And it'd crush him to hear from Rowan some whispered regret Rowan'd heard from Paisley. Imagine the hurt if Paisley considered it a mistake? The longer the subject remained untouched, the longer he could pretend everything was okay.

It wasn't long until Rowan slunk from the kitchen and joined Paisley in the shower. Made sense. Paisley was his girlfriend, after all. But the exclusion hurt.

He flip-phoned one of the British backpackers who'd loaned them the bikes this morning. They were excited to hear from him. He told them their Maltese friends wanted them all to go out tonight and they already knew about it. They arranged to meet in forty-five minutes outside the gates of the Sa Malson Garden. There would be a convoy of three vehicles heading up to a beach bar in Paceville with two levels of dance floors.

When Paisley and Rowan emerged from the bathroom, he let them know the plan.

In the shower he soaped himself, lamenting how he was removing Paisley from his skin. There were particles of that girl on his body and he sloughed

them off and said goodbye to them down the drain. Washing away the amazing thing that happened this afternoon . . . But that would be the way it had to be. There was no way around it: Paisley was Rowan's girl. So when he shaved in the mirror, he told his reflection to grow up. Be a big boy. You did the right thing when you gave her to Rowan. Sure, things were better now for him. Sometimes, though, no matter how great something could've been, it never would be. Just cherish what happened today.

Then he dressed for the club, came out to the kitchen to find Paisley and Rowan ready to go.

They walked together through the old neighborhoods of Valetta till they found the Garden. A half-dozen people their age hung around under a palm tree. They introduced themselves and found they were in the right group. Some Germans, some different Brits, and two cute Hungarian girls.

The Maltese and the British he'd called showed up two minutes later. Everybody boarded three hatchbacks, and the convoy drove twenty minutes north to the Paceville district of St. Julian.

In the club, he got separated from Paisley and Rowan. Hung around with two British girls, dancing with them, chatting and drinking. They went out back and did coke together. It loosened him up.

Back on the dance floor under the strobing blue lights, Rowan found him. Clapping him on the back, shouting in his ear whether he was having a good time or not. Then Paisley was there, and his night brightened. But she danced with Rowan, and that hurt his heart again.

The three of them hung out, bodies bustling against each other. There was a moment when Paisley danced against him that he thought she was sending him signals. She danced and ground her butt against his crotch. But he was too afraid to put his hands on her waist in case she danced away from him in objection.

PAISLEY

Around one in the morning, the Maltese found them on the second floor. It was time to get going. Their group filtered out onto the Paceville streets looking for something to eat. The district was packed, shoulder-to-shoulder with amped-up young people.

She lost Grady, then she lost Rowan, but they were reunited out front of the Hard Rock. Rowan took her hand.

She and Rowan and Grady and one of the Hungarian girls split street-side fries and a Coke. Afterward, they got swept up with the others, drawn in the flow of reveler traffic heading to the beach.

That was where they were now. Sitting at St. George's Bay while Paceville's flashing neon painted its color on the night-black waves. Hundreds filled the small beach. There were guys running out and diving into the water in their underwear, some girls too. But her group sat in a cross-legged ring around a small fire. She talked with Cecelia, a tattooed British girl she liked who she met at the gate of Sa Malson. An impromptu soccer game had started up, Grady and Rowan joining in. Her two guys out kicking the ball around with some Europeans. Shirtless, her guys' bodies attracted a lot of attention.

It was an eerie night. Strange sitting on a beach with the throb of music and watching guys play soccer bathed in casino light. Rain began, only a mist, and it made their muscles shine. Cecelia watched them too. She passed her a joint, and Paisley took her turn. Passed it on. Cecelia shouted over the noise: "You're traveling across Europe with them?" She nodded her chin toward Rowan and Grady running near after a successful play.

She nodded, leaned close and shouted, “Just Rowan. Rowan’s my boyfriend.”

“Oh yeah—Where did you meet Grady, then?”

“Grady’s an old friend.” Then some truth she felt like broadcasting: “We dated.”

Cecilia made an eager expression. “You dated Grady, too?”

“A long time ago,” she said, liking the attention it’d brought. Yes, she dated both of those guys who had all the girls’ attention. She said, “Rowan and I are going west, Grady’s going east. We just agreed to meet up for two days in Malta.”

“Too much to handle, anyway,” Cecilia said, “two days with those two would kill a normal girl.”

“I wouldn’t say that,” she said, “it’s them who have a hard time handling me.” A sly answer that surprised her.

Cecilia studied her profile, and she felt an unstoppable smile. She turned, tried not to laugh, looking at the girl’s disbelief. She burst out laughing and looked away.

“Go on, get out,” Cecilia ribbed her.

She waved it off, but Cecilia still stared, and she still beamed.

Cecilia leaned in again. “Why would you want only one of those if you could have both?”

ROWAN

One of the Maltese soccer players invited them over to his ring of friends. The Maltese had hidden a cooler of beer by the barrier between beach and the street. They stood and talked for a while, but then he and Grady wandered off. Grady led the way. Maybe he finally wanted to talk.

Grady leaned his butt on the concrete slab below the high painted railing. Hundreds of people traveled by on the street behind their backs. It was noisy, and Rowan got close so they could talk. He put his butt next to Grady's, shoulders touching, leaned to clink beer bottles. They drank. Grady wiped his mouth with the back of his hand. His expression was heavy, like something weighed on him.

Rowan prompted: "If you want to say something, I want to hear it."

Grady pushed the base of his beer bottle down into the sand to make sure it would stay upright. He rubbed at his face, pushed his hair back, looked out over the heads of the people sitting on the beach and out to the bay. Twenty feet to their left sat the group they'd come with, ringed around a fire.

He waited Grady out. At last, Grady said, "We should talk about what happened."

"I didn't want to bring it up unless you wanted to."

"It's been driving me crazy all day."

"I'll hear whatever you want to say."

Grady growled and rubbed fingers through his hair like it was a big deal. But Rowan didn't think it was.

Grady said, "Maybe we shouldn't have done it."

It surprised him. He said, "Of all the people out on the rock today, you being the one with regrets is surprising."

"It's not that," Grady said. "There's something I should've said beforehand."

Now he frowned, suddenly thinking they should have used a condom. But Grady would never jeopardize them like that. Never. Still, his fingertips tingled.

Grady heard his own words back, then looked to Rowan, disgusted. Like he'd read Rowan's thoughts. "Not like that, you idiot."

"I didn't say a thing."

"It's not that at all," Grady said, rubbing his face again. He took a deep breath, then said, "I . . . really care about Paisley."

"I know you do."

"No, Rowan. I mean . . . I still . . . I have feelings for her."

It wasn't exactly surprising. But Grady attributing so much weight to that particular angle did seem troubling. "Why is that a problem?"

"I shouldn't have done what I did. Not without telling you the truth first."

Now he chuckled, pushed his own beer bottle down into the sand and rubbed his face. "Is that what's been bothering you?"

"It is," Grady said, then looked his way. "I mean real feelings, Rowan."

He breathed deep, contemplating. "We can both love her."

It was a heavy load of information for Grady and he looked momentarily overwhelmed. “I would never get between you guys.”

“Grady, that’s kind. But you couldn’t.”

Competitiveness flashed in Grady’s eyes. Then fizzled. He said, “That might have been the best thing you could have said.”

“Was that worrying you—that I’d be . . . challenged?”

“Of course.”

“I had the best afternoon of my life. Paisley did, too.”

“She did?”

“I’m pretty sure she did.”

“She doesn’t regret it?”

He shook his head no. “You really worried about that?”

Grady nodded, looking down into the sand, lifting his bottle to chug before returning it again. Grady said, “That dirty talk . . . what you wanted Paisley to repeat . . .?”

Now he groaned, touched an eyebrow with his knuckle and felt uncomfortable. “What about it?”

“You like that? You’re cool with it?”

He nodded.

Grady said, “Just . . . you know. I don’t want you to be challenged.” Grady looked his way like he didn’t want to have to illustrate what he was trying to say.

He figured what he meant. “I like it. I like that she likes it, I mean.” Yes, your dick is way bigger than mine and Paisley definitely likes it. No

understanding of that weirdness on his own part, just that it turned him on to see his girlfriend's reaction.

He changed the subject: "I don't want to be an asshole, but, let's be real: you know it and I know it . . . you passing Paisley to me was the biggest mistake you could have made." He tried to look serious, but it broke, and he smiled.

Grady groaned, looked away, put his forearms over knees and watched the bay. "It was."

"I know it was," he said, "but really, if it makes you feel better, it was the kindest thing you ever could have done. For me. I think about it all the time. Think how my life would be if you hadn't done that. Paisley's been my rock. She's everything. If it's Paisley who's keeping you away from me, then we're going to have to get over it. Maybe what we did today will bring you back into our life. I want you in my life."

"I passed Paisley to you for Paisley's sake."

"Not for mine?"

Grady smiled and shook his head. "I cared about her and I knew you'd be good for her. And . . . I wanted her to stay in my life too. I have to be honest."

"Thought you could steal her away from me when the time was right?"

"Never. But I'd scoop her up if you let her go."

He grabbed his friend's shoulder and shook him lightly. "It'll never happen. No offense: I'm not going to make the same mistake you made."

Grady groaned again, dipped his chin to his wrist and rubbed it.

He patted Grady's back. "I'm trying to be funny, but Grady, I am serious. I love that girl so much. I love her and I'm not unwilling to share."

Grady chuckled, looked at the light on the waves a moment, then cocked his head toward Rowan, an eyebrow raised dubiously.

“I mean it,” he told Grady. “You can’t take her from me. I have zero fear in my heart. But if you care for her, there’s room in our lives for you.”

His friend studied his face for a while, contemplating, looking at all the angles and trajectories and getting right to the point: “But where does that lead?”

“I don’t care,” he said. “What do you mean?—like how both of us can’t marry her, both of us can’t put babies in her?”

“Jesus, dude . . .”

“She’s mine, Grady. No doubt about it, but if she’ll open her heart to you, I’m all in. Whatever that means is up to Paisley.”

Now they both turned and leaned their backs against the upright rails, watching over at their group of travelers. The soccer game gone, everyone talking and drinking beers; Paisley sat close with one of the British girls watching them. He and Grady both waved, and Paisley waved back. The British girl leaned and whispered something to Paisley, Paisley whispered back, and the two girls broke up laughing.

“They’re talking about us,” Grady said.

Rowan said, “That Brit wants you.”

“She’s hot.”

“If she makes a move . . .”

Grady’s expression went solemn, Grady understanding the logic. Rowan continued on a more positive angle: “If the Brit doesn’t make a move, Paisley warned her off. She wants you for herself.”

PAISLEY

The smell of talc and seagrass overtop a low masculine musk meant it was Grady's arms in which she woke. Rowan was musk and woods, sometimes campfire. This was what she thought as her eyes fluttered open.

Indeed, her cheek rested in Grady's armpit. Grady was sleeping.

She sat up, rubbed the back of her neck. Still clothed. Grady shirtless, wearing shorts. Over her shoulder, Rowan slept. No shirt as well. She still wore her white cotton top and her shorts. Barefoot. There was sand between her toes. They were going to have to shake these sheets out before they washed them today.

The bed was small, and she lay between two amazing guys. Yesterday, after coming back from Marsaxlokk, Rowan had slipped into the shower with her. It was the first time alone since she'd had sex with Grady. They didn't even really talk about it. Not what happened, at least. Rowan told her she was amazing, she told him he was amazing. And without having to ask, he let her know how he saw the future: It's up to you, Paisley. Whatever you want to do, I am all in.

She lay back down, barely enough space between them for her to fit. She'd slept sandwiched, cheek on Grady, but now she faced Rowan. Amazing Rowan. And she contemplated what "whatever you want to do" meant. It had been a loaded statement, but she felt like it wasn't a trap.

She smiled now, touched his lower lip. Warm morning sunlight bathed their small apartment, making the polished floor gleam. She kissed Rowan's chest, and it got him stirring. Kissed lower, her lips riding over the curves

of the muscles on his ribs and stomach. Once again, Rowan had woken with aching prominent morning wood.

Quiet as she could, she worked out his belt from the buckle, snapped open his shorts and drew down the zipper. Underwear gently pulled down, the tip of his arousal was revealed. She kissed it softly, lips sticking to his skin.

Now he was awake, legs moving, looking around dazed. She waited for him to register the morning. He looked down to see she'd revealed his penis. Saw her smiling up at him. Over to Grady, still sleeping. He smiled back at her, his eyes going narrow. She kissed the tip of his erection again, began to peel his underwear lower, getting the whole thing naked, even his testicles—each one she kissed gingerly.

Then she was sitting, pulling off his shorts and tossing them to the floor. Now her generous boyfriend was totally naked. Naked in bed with his best friend and her. She peeled off her top, worked her way to lay between them again, facing Rowan, who took her in his arms.

ROWAN

Paisley's action made clear her decision. And he couldn't be happier. He moved his hands on her warm bare skin and took her mouth. His hands unhooked her bra, drew down the bra straps and flung it aside. He embraced her hard; she squirmed over top of his body, his erection accidentally poking up the inside of her short leg and getting them both laughing into each other's mouths.

He rolled her to her side again, her back against Grady, unbuttoned her shorts and zipped them down. They worked together to get them off, removing her panties as well. She put a knee up, resting the inside of her thigh over the fronts of his. She stroked his cock while he rubbed her ass, then began to tease at her opening with the pads of his fingers. "You're wet," he whispered.

Paisley nodded, kissed the tip of his nose. He brought his hand up, used her wetness to run slippery circles on her nipple. She drew a hissing intake of breath, tucking her chin down, both of them watching how hard her nipple could bunch up.

"You're so amazing," he whispered now.

"You're so amazing, too," she said, "I love you so much."

Body squirming on top of him again, stacked like pancakes, his cock divided her sexy butt cheeks as they kissed and she ran her fingernails through his hair. He stroked her lower back and squeezed her ass cheeks, then whispered, "Wake him up . . ."

GRADY

The British girl with the tattoos had pushed him up against an alley wall. Their noses were burning from coke. She tried to kiss him, squeezing his dick through his pants. He was reluctant to give her his mouth, struggling not to surrender . . .

His eyes opened.

The British girl hadn't done that . . . The British girl wanted to do that . . . But Paisley had told her she wanted Grady for herself . . .

Simple linear thoughts, but as his eyes fluttered, and he looked up at the high ceiling of the ancient apartment, they were being stitched together slowly. Reality coalesced. What persisted was the feeling of his cock being handled through his shorts.

Now he snorted, tucked his chin to his chest, eyes wide. He almost burst out laughing, seeing the expression on the face that met him. A comical mix of lust, surprise, and prankishness. It was Paisley, completely naked, her thumb and first three fingers clearly finding the shape of his penis under the khaki cotton of his shorts.

"What are you doing?" he asked, getting up on an elbow. And shit, Rowan right there next to her, naked as a jaybird—his best buddy's cock doing its usual morning sun ritual. He felt like he'd just walked into a surprise party.

Paisley climbed up his body while Rowan watched. He was still groggy, trying to piece together what was happening. His hands went out and took a tentative hold on Paisley's slim sides. Her breasts hung, swaying as she made her way to his mouth. He wanted to cup them, but she flattened them

on his chest and kissed him. Instead, he embraced her, feeling her lithe body against his. He breathed her in, took her tongue in his mouth, reeled at the feel of her nails against his scalp.

Then her mouth was gone, her on all fours over top of him, kissing his chest, taking his nipple into her mouth and suckling. Now he cupped her breasts, held them, felt their gentle weight in his palms. He looked to Rowan, who watched blankly, the smallest smile pulled to one side. Rowan said nothing, and he said nothing too. Paisley kissed lower, over his sternum, then darting out her tongue and tracing it along the ridges of his stomach muscles. Her hands hooked under the front of his shorts, unbuttoned them, drew down his fly. Now she glanced to Rowan, including him, dipping her face down and plucking at the pubic hair sprouting from the V of his open fly with her lips. She drew an inhale, raised up again.

She looked to Rowan, then back to him. “I feel like some horse cock this morning,” she said, then bit her lower lip. Paisley was testing the waters. Gauging Rowan’s reaction, and knowing the dirty thing she said would rile him, too—engaging both of the men in her bed. Rowan groaned, rubbed his own leg, then cupped his balls.

Paisley giggled, satisfied with the reaction, and began tugging down on his shorts again, taking them to his thighs and baring his genitals. He raised his legs, let her peel the shorts away, then she crawled back over his thighs. His cock lay heavy over his testicles, the tip in the bedding, but already beginning to rise. Paisley hefted it, levered its sleepy weight, and let it plop back onto his belly. She admired its underside, touched it with her fingertips. She lowered her face, and his scalp tightened feeling her breath between his legs, making his balls roll over in their sack. She kissed his testicles; he closed his eyes. Then she ran the tip of her tongue between his balls, up the belly of his hardening member. She kissed it, raised it up again, held it in her hand and tested its weight. Studied the way it moved, pulling gently back on the foreskin, then closing it again to a pucker. He raised his knees, forcing her to get on all fours over top of him again, face over his. He took her in his arms, and said, “Before we do anything, I need to know what this is.”

She nodded, looking in his eyes but not saying anything. It took moments before he realized she waited for him to tell her what it was. He said, "From you, Paisley. I want to know what this is for you."

Rowan helped him. He touched Paisley's arm, said, "Grady wants to talk first."

She frowned at Rowan, then looked back to him. "You guys talked."

Rowan said, "We did."

Paisley said, "Is this something?" A questioning yet hopeful tone.

But it chilled him to think that it wasn't automatic. That Paisley didn't just jump into his arms and say this is everything he wanted it to be. He said, "I don't want to be your sex toy."

She looked concerned. "You're not."

"You don't sound convincing."

"I swear you're not Grady, I swear," she said, smiling like he was being glib, but he wasn't.

"I don't want to be . . . I don't want my dick to be why you're with me."

She stared at him, curious at first, then her beautiful face softening, maybe seeing it from his perspective. She soothed a hand on his shoulder. "Grady, I had a crush on you before I ever thought of you sexually."

"When we dated?"

"Yeah. Oh yeah. I appreciated you breaking it off with me if you weren't into it, but . . . it hurt."

"I didn't want it to. And we weren't serious."

"I thought there was something wrong with me, maybe."

“Oh my God, don’t think that.” He stroked her arm.

“Not now. Back then—”

“I know-I know . . .”

“I was seventeen, and I had hardly ever had a boyfriend.”

“I wanted to put you on hold till I got my shit together.”

“You set me up with this guy,” she said, reaching over to grip Rowan who smiled. “The best guy in the world,” she added.

He scratched his cheek, looked away, back at her.

Rowan spoke up saying, “I don’t want this because I like watching you fuck her with your big dick—”

“Oh God, Rowan,” Paisley groaned and hid her face against Grady’s chest like she was embarrassed.

He chuckled and groaned too, Rowan making them both uncomfortable.

Rowan said, “What . . .?—if that’s what you’re thinking—look, I mean, it’s not for my benefit. Do I like watching that? For sure. Is it about me? No, not really.” Then, eyes on Paisley, he said, “It’s about you. I want to know whatever it is you want to explore. I like us together—all three of us, I mean—and if you feel like it’s something that intrigues you, if you want to get to know Grady better, I want that too.”

Rowan’d put Paisley on the spot in front of him. She chewed her lower lip, looked from Rowan to him, then back to Rowan. Voice very quiet, she said, “I’d like to . . . explore . . . something, I guess.” Then to Grady: “If you want that too.”

“I do,” he said, heart swelling with the possibility.

Then, with no preamble or warning, she moved closer, eyes on his, her mouth poised to kiss. His hands went to hold her upper arms; their mouths

connected. It was soft and sweet and different from yesterday. Not about sex or passion, but her mouth seeking something new from him. She pulled back, liking it, smiling, looking past him at Rowan. Just with one kiss, he could feel a change in their relationship.

PAISLEY

As her kisses made their way down Grady's chest and onto his stomach, she knew Rowan watched her. Watched her because he loved it. And that was amazing. Not because he was sharing, allowing her this amazing other man in her life, what amazed her was how it thrilled Rowan. She would perform for him.

She nudged Grady's cock with her cheek, could feel it still heavy but getting turgid. It rolled, and its skin stuck to hers. She looked around and smiled; her hand swept the bedding to find Rowan's. They clenched, squeezed, she let him go.

Now she kissed her way until she straddled Grady's thighs again, Grady touching her hair as she kissed his stomach on either side of his wide cock. The way he touched her showed his emotion. She'd felt it yesterday on the rock, too. That wasn't a threesome about sex. Everything Grady'd done with her was done with passion.

Her fingertips explored his manhood again, looking at it up close as her fingers traced the gummy wrinkled skin closing its end. It was swelling, widening. When she licked it, it lengthened. Now she bit her lower lip as her fingertips squeezed near the end and eased the skin back until the cloven underside of his purplish gleaming cock head was revealed. She traced its plump shapes with the tip of her tongue before swallowing his glans. He wasn't fully hard yet, and it was heavy and wanted to flop out of her mouth. She gripped it hard, forced blood into the cock head, then pleased him with her bobbing mouth. It got Grady squirming, and she watched his stomach muscles work as she gave him pleasure. And she tested Rowan again, letting Grady's cock slip out of her mouth, and while

she stroked its floppy boneless heft, looking at Rowan, she said, “His cock is so big, baby.” And it was like she’d fanned lust in his face, some sort of narcotic dust. Rowan’s eyes practically rolled up and his eyelashes fluttered. She bit her lip and stifled a giggle. If they were going to work together, they’d have to know each other’s buttons. Which ones to press and which ones not to press. So she took Grady’s cock in both hands, stroked and sucked while Rowan watched her and Grady touched her shoulders, face, and hair. He hardened in her mouth, so large she couldn’t take him deep.

She tongued his cock head, looked to Grady saying, “I love your cock so much,” for Rowan’s benefit, “Rowan’s is shorter and not as thick . . .”

That got Grady chuckling, knowing what she was up to, appreciating the words but understanding it was for Rowan. “Rowan’s a grower. I love that you’re a shower—I love how big it is when you’re just walking around. I could watch it flop between your legs all day. It’s so sexy . . .” Now she kissed between his balls, ran her tongue up his length, kissed his stomach muscles, sucked his cock again, knowing Rowan was being driven wild by her doing the things she really wanted to do, and saying the things she really wanted to say . . .

ROWAN

Grady'd got fully hard in Paisley's mouth. She sat up then, stroked it with both hands, getting it wet from fat head to wide base. It looked huge in her small and pretty hands. Paisley liked to roll his foreskin up over the glans, then peel it back again. She liked the plump shape of his cock head. And she was crazy horny for Grady.

He watched the muscles in her legs move, could see the slow circles her hips made over Grady's thighs. She was gyrating against him, that opening between her legs hungry to be fed. Probably dripping wet. He ached all over in the craziest, most lustful loving way. It drove him wild to see her with Grady. But he would give Grady what Grady wanted now.

He rose, moved on his knees next to Paisley, put his hand on the small of her back and she moved her mouth to kiss him. He kissed her once, touching her neck, his other hand dropping down over the curve of her rump and slipping in between her legs. She was even wetter than he anticipated. He stroked her opening back and forward, dipped his fingers inside until her breath trembled across his lips. Then he brought the fingers up the middle of her crack, touched her lower back again.

He said, "I want you two to make love. I want you to do it the way you want. Okay?"

She looked in his eyes, still chewing her lower lip, one hand still stroking Grady's huge cock. Grady's stomach moved in and out with heavy breath, his eyes wide and eager. Grady nodded, grateful.

“Okay,” he said, and kissed Paisley again. “I’m going to make some coffee. You guys have fun.”

Then he was backing off the bed, his cock so hard it was like a throbbing crowbar upright between his legs, veins blistering its sides. He watched them, stepping backward toward the kitchen as Paisley lay across Grady, his cock between them, Grady’s hands moving all over her. They kissed and breathed loudly against each other, mouths popping and sucking.

By the time he was in the kitchen, filling the kettle (spilling it down the side because he wasn’t looking), Paisley was reaching behind her, trying to find Grady’s manhood. She did, sitting up, easing forward on her knees, weight on one hand, aiming that huge tool at her opening. Got it in place, hands on Grady’s chest then, she slowly sank back on him. He loved the sound she made as Grady split her wide. He watched that pink ring of Paisley’s sex stretched thin as it did its best to accommodate his friend’s massive manhood.

Kettle flicked on, he watched, arms folded, his cock throbbing upright with his heartbeat, staying out of their way but still part of it because he was watching with love every move his Paisley made on his best friend. Who was now apparently allowed to be the third member of their relationship. Paisley’s decision. He’d told Grady he wasn’t scared, but that was a lie. Somehow that hidden fear only heightened his arousal.

Paisley did most of the work in their lovemaking, her thighs flexing, lifting and lowering her rump, taking Grady deep in her body. They went slow at first, and then Paisley palmed an ass cheek, took him even deeper. She let out a quavering sound that almost would make you think she didn’t like how it felt. Only he knew she did. And then she was bouncing again, then leaning back, putting her hands on Grady’s knees, swiveling her hips with that long fat cock buried inside her.

His own cock pulsed lubricant, so eager for his turn, but being patient, streams running down his cock’s belly, tangling in the pubic hair on his scrotum and dripping onto the kitchen floor.

PAISLEY

The imaginary heat of Rowan's gaze burned on her back, so she performed for her boyfriend—shimmying her hips with Grady deep inside her, arching her back, flexing her arms and rolling her shoulders so her shoulder blades would dance against her tanned skin. She tossed her hair, she would even sometimes lean forward, putting her hands on Grady's chest to expose to Rowan where his best friend's huge manhood stretched her wide. There was something in Rowan that liked to watch her. If he wanted to watch, then she would perform.

But soon, their lovemaking rolled over on her thoughts of Rowan. If the three of them were to make this work, she would consider Rowan, but she would have to surrender herself to her new lover, Grady. And it was easy to do that. His lovemaking consumed her.

And the idea that Rowan would allow her to explore more than just a physical relationship with Grady sent a thrill up inside her. She would get to know Grady. She'd always feared she might have been the thing that drove a wedge between Rowan and his best friend. Hated to think that and then cursed herself believing it was insane ego that would have her believing something so crazy. But now it was obvious it wasn't. Grady had feelings for her. And she'd put her feelings for Grady way behind. But now, with Rowan watching, she would sort through the things Grady did to her heart when she was a teen. Everyone knew Grady was in a much better place now, and if he was willing to surrender her to Rowan when the timing was wrong, then he would only return and engage when the timing was right. She trusted that Grady was now ready to love her right.

She sat back, almost upright, loving the feel of his cock inside her body. He was so big he stretched her. Stretched her till she felt tight. No more pain, just the first time he penetrated her. Now it was only a sense of throbbing fullness. And a depth she couldn't believe.

She ran her hand in a circle around her navel, arching her back, swearing she felt the knot of Grady's huge cock head against her tummy wall. She let out a warbling moan—it was an honest one, but it was also for Rowan's benefit.

Then she was forward again, resting her hands on Grady's muscular chest, looking in his beautiful eyes and connecting with him. He gently thrummed his hips upward in a rhythm she loved, and she rode on his thrusts, rotating her pelvis in circles, his cock so deep, its tip probing that front wall and teasing an orgasm that threatened to split her in two.

Eyes open but mind focused on chasing down this gargantuan orgasm swell that had her ears ringing, she got her feet on the mattress on either side of Grady's hips, bracing hands on his hard body. Grady grabbed her upper arms, supporting her. His cock was in her diaphragm, god, so deep, she swore he'd moved her insides around to accommodate it. Then she fucked him with force, crying out with each deep thrust, eyes narrowing, mouth hanging open, nails scoring over Grady's unbelievable body, drawing lines on the hard plates of stomach muscle pressed up against his tight skin . . .

Then his hand gripped the back of her neck tight. Both her hands gripped his strong forearm. They looked into each other's eyes, both of them lost in a blood-pounding lust. His hips pumped hard, matching her own thrusts, both of them working in immediate rhythm, making her cry out how big his cock was inside her, how his cock felt so good, how she was going to come all over it while Grady's big balls beat against her butthole, and her ass slapped his thighs.

GRADY

It was easy to think he was alone with Paisley now, his view of Rowan blocked by the girl Grady had lusted after for the last five years. More than lust.

It was all right if his friend wanted to watch. If they wanted this to be a three-person relationship, they would find ways to make it work. So while Paisley bellowed out in her high sweet voice as she orgasmed, he pulled her to his chest, and she bit at his neck. Her whole body trembled against him as she came. He still pulsed his cock into her, going gentle, feeling her pussy's grip quivering on him. She exhaled warbled sounds of pleasure into his ear, and he ran his hands up her back, eyeing Rowan standing in the kitchen and watching, leaning on the countertop with his dick pointing to the ceiling.

But it wasn't Rowan's turn yet. Paisley was still his.

He touched fingertips down her sides, got her softly chuckling now. The fingertips worked to her stomach, and he could feel her whole body flinching. He was learning where Paisley was ticklish. "Was that good?"

She hummed an affirmation, her breath loud in his ear, getting his nipples hard. She took his earlobe in her mouth and suckled. He stroked her back, began drawing his hips further away, producing a longer stroke in her body. She moaned in his ear, bit his earlobe again and then whispered, "I want you in my mouth when you come."

It spiked him with a feeling of acceptance that raced his heart. "You want that?"

“I want to taste you,” she whispered.

Powerful words that got his heart beating fast. He bucked her aside, got her on her back, Paisley’s arms going out to the side as she lifted her knees, feet pointed on the ridge of his hips. He pulled out fully, lay his cock on her stomach, humped its belly on her soft skin while she watched and stroked the top side. Then she gripped it, pushed it down and guided it inside her again.

He sunk himself in and she cried out. Then he was rolling his hips, taking her mouth, kissing her neck; she grabbed his arms, and he got on his knees, leaning back, putting one of her ankles over his shoulder then gripping her neck. He fucked her fast. Got her crying out to the ceiling. He closed the hand gently on her throat. Paisley’s eyes went wide with excitement, and he knew right away that Rowan had never fucked her like this. And knew Paisley wanted to be fucked like this.

They went like that for a long time, going fast, going slow, thumbing at her clit, turning her hip to the side, fucking her sideways, gently spanking her ass, pushing her rump down, flattening two big hands on her cheeks then fucking her hard and deep, face down and prone on the mattress, legs lightly kicking while she sang notes of high-octane passion. Paisley moaned and cried the whole time, thrashing in the sheets, and then she was on her back again, embracing him, rolling, making love, the two of them working together.

He whispered, “I’m ready.”

Paisley scooted down his body, and he went to his back. She lovingly took his cock in her mouth, looked in his eyes as her head bobbed up and down with his foreskin fully retracted, two hands stroking. A masterful blow job. She’d only ever been with Rowan, but she knew how to give pleasure. He thumbed her cheek, cupped her ear, looked in her eyes the whole time as she drew from him his orgasm.

Watching the wriggling ring of her lips sealed around his pulsing member in the bright morning light got his breaths feathering through his lungs, his breathing becoming an airy chuffing ignited by the tickle of her lips on his

sensitive cock head as he ejaculated in her mouth. She gripped, stroked, moaned, and drank from his cock as he gushed hot liquid pleasure. She drank it all, making horny noises in her throat to let him know she wanted it, breath snorting, squeezing his cock, screwing her mouth on him now to get every drop.

ROWAN

When Grady ejaculated in Paisley's waiting mouth, he almost collapsed. Grady's legs twitched and kicked in the sheets, Paisley hunched between his knees, the knobs of her spine pressed out on her back. Her head had bobbed until Grady roared and thrust upward his hips, and Paisley hadn't taken her head away. She'd swallowed his come.

He'd slumped right down the kitchen cupboards, weight supported on elbows, any remaining strength leaking out his feet and across the floor like spilled water. It was the most erotic and dirty sight he'd ever seen. But intimate, too—wonderful in its way to see Paisley share something like that with someone he cared about. His heart twisted with wild emotion. Contradictory thoughts that had him wrenched. Hating it, loving it, wanting to be part of it, loving Paisley, love for Grady too . . . but mostly present was the urge to reclaim Paisley again, to make known his presence. And to put his cock inside her. To come inside her. To remind her who was her man.

As he slowly recouped his legs, beginning to rise, Paisley's head came up, and Grady was looking in her eyes. She drew a wrist over her mouth, though he couldn't see her face, he knew she was happy. Sure enough, she collapsed on the bed next to Grady, cuddling against him and giggling. A little ashamed of the dirty thing she'd done, maybe, and looking for validation from the new man in her bed. A look on her pretty face—tanned with blushed cheeks—that said, That wasn't too dirty, was it? It wasn't for him, and he was her boyfriend, and Grady sure looked appreciative, letting her settle against his side and putting an arm under her head. The enamored look in Paisley's eyes got his feet moving, crossing the floor to join them on the small bed.

He slipped in behind her, front cupped to her back, his cock poking into her and making her yelp a comical sound. She regarded him over her shoulder, smiling but sleepy looking—a satisfied look—and her hand reached around and gripped his cock. He pulsed pre-come against her wrist.

“Hi, baby,” she whispered.

He asked, “Did he fuck you good?”

She chuckled, her eyes darting over his, studying him. “He fucked me so good, baby.”

He kissed her lips, and the hand on his cock came up to cup his cheek. He said, “Yeah, you came all over his cock.”

“He’s so big,” she said, tilting her hip away so he could see between her and Grady that she was handling Grady’s slippery member, the big flesh club flopping in her hand.

“You like his cock?”

She looked to Grady now, said, “I love his cock.” Grady kissed her.

“I like watching you two fuck. You look so good.”

She turned, said, “I want to fuck all day—you’re going to make me come now.”

“I can’t wait,” he said, sucking the warm skin of her shoulder.

She said, “Can you do it?”

“Make you come? I know I can.”

“Show me. Show Grady how you make me come . . .”

It was mesmerizing to see the protective scales of Paisley’s sexuality pulled away and showing a first glimpse of her vulnerable and delicate bud. A flower would grow from this unfurling petal just now meeting light, and if

he and Grady nurtured it, what would she become for them? Paisley was always sexual, but her eagerness to be with two different men came with little reserve. She welcomed them. Wanted them. Wanted to do dirty things with them. Out of nowhere, his relationship with this young woman had grown deeper and profounder. Both of them, as Grady had said, of the same mind. He wanted to watch her with Grady. She wanted him to watch her with Grady. They were meant for each other.

When she felt him moving against her back, trying to get his cock angled, she arched her back and thrust out her rump, giving him access to her pussy. Her sex looked worn in and happy, the lips engorged and receptive. Her pussy had been fucked. He pushed himself inside her, and she moaned. He watched her teeth clamp down on the muscle of Grady's shoulder. He fucked her, watching her mouth move on his friend's skin.

He asked, "Can you feel it?"

She sighed, "Is it all the way in?" Playing his game.

He rammed her hard till his hips hit. She chirped as her body bounced against Grady. He slunk against her back, got his mouth near her ear, whispering, "All the way in."

She said, "Grady goes so deep, baby, he gets so deep inside me . . ." To illustrate, her hand let go Grady's cock and rubbed her tummy right around her navel. Then she searched for his hand and led it between Grady's legs.

"Feel him," she purred, taking his hand and guiding it to Grady's cock, putting his grip on his friend's manhood—letting her, only so he'd know what his girlfriend's hand felt when she held it. The lusty look on her face surprised him—his girlfriend aroused by her two men comparing each other and touching each other. Her sexuality was perplexing but a wondrous discovery. She was a dirty girl. Dirtier than he'd ever imagined. He couldn't be more in love with her.

She said, "It's big, isn't it?"

Grady was so much thicker, his half-hard cock heavy in his hand. It felt odd to hold another penis than his own familiar piece—and the difference was astounding; the thickness, the heft . . .

Paisley whispered, “He’s slippery from my pussy, stroke him with my pussy juice . . .” Then bit her lip, embarrassed again by her own lewdness.

So he stroked Grady’s cock, kissing Paisley’s shoulder, his own cock buried inside her to the hilt, her ass cheeks on his thighs. His hand stroked, Paisley’s moved to hold Grady’s big balls. “I want him in my pussy again,” she said, “I want his stretch, okay?” Even Grady groaned and closed his eyes, overcome by the eroticism of Paisley’s desire and lust.

He said, “You like his size better?”

“Uh-huh, he fills me, stretches me . . .” She writhed between her two men, her movement making slippery pleasure light up his brain with the feeling on his cock.

“Am I second place now?”

Her hand had left Grady’s balls, went over her hip, and now he felt them close on his sack and gently squeeze. “Sometimes I’m going to want him more than you.”

“I love you,” he said, pleasure lightening his vision.

“I love you too. Is that okay? I want his big cock right now.”

“Fuck, you guys are killing me,” Grady said, hand over his brow now, closing his eyes while Paisley dirty-talked and took over jerking him.

Then both he and Paisley broke up chuckling at what they were doing to their third. He bit Paisley’s shoulder.

Grady watched them like they were crazy, then smiled, shifted to face them on his side saying, “Fuck her now, Rowan, fuck her from behind till she gets me hard again,” shimmying higher up the bed, hip in the pillows, and he gripped his cock near the base, and lay it along Paisley’s cheek.

Paisley took his cock in a hand, pulled back the foreskin, and put her mouth on his glans, still leaking semen. She sucked him hungrily, wanting him hard while her boyfriend fucked her. Wanted her new lover hard so he could take over . . .

Why was it erotic to be pushed to second place in his girlfriend's list of lovers? Why was that so fucking arousing? No anger at her, in fact the opposite: he loved her for being honest and allowing him to be a part of her secret sexuality. Grady could be her primary lover, he would take the back seat, but he would be her primary mate, the love of her life, the one who had the strongest grip on her heart. And he would hope his grip never weakened. Like Grady told him: he would be there to scoop her up. So he would love Paisley harder than Grady ever could. He welcomed the challenge.

PAISLEY

It didn't take long for Grady to get hard again while Rowan fucked her. And she loved making love to Grady's cock with her mouth. It was supple and large, and she liked to pluck at his foreskin with her lips, make it close and nibble on the bunched membranes, then peel it back and tongue-tickle the exposed head. But once he was hard, she wanted more penetration—wanted to get stretched. And she didn't need to ask Rowan—he pulled from her, put hands on her hips and guided her to climb up onto Grady as he shifted lower on the bed. She hiked a leg over his lap, straddled him, and Rowan aimed Grady's cock against her opening. She sat, taking his larger cock inside her body again, amazed at how a different size and shape of cock could feel so distinct. Grady humped his hips up while he sat, and she rocked her pussy on him, working him deep. Rowan rubbed her back.

Then her two boys were moving her, making faces she couldn't see, communicating to each other how they were going to fuck her, Rowan guiding her knees higher, Grady bracing her arms.

Then Rowan was on her back and she knew what they intended, jolting, looking up and seeing Rowan's face over her shoulder. He said, "Tell me to stop when you want," then kissed her back, his hand cupping a breast, her nipple aching against his palm. When she looked at Grady, he kissed her. She resumed her humping, rolling her stomach against Grady's, his cock buried in her, and Rowan got on his knees, one hand on her side, the other guiding the point of his cock.

There was an amazing feeling being between two men who loved you and cared about you, who were seeking to give you pleasure. Sometimes she could feel her power, feel it was her sexuality that controlled them, but once

they were hard and they were inside her, it was them who had control. And she could submit to them all day and all night if they could keep their cocks up.

Grady asked: “You ready?”

She nodded and laughed, waited . . .

With Grady’s cock stretching her pussy, she could now feel the head of Rowan’s cock pushing against her anus. Anal sex was not something they did often, but it wasn’t out of the question. Besides, this was all crazy territory they were stepping foot in anyway, why be shy now?

As her sphincter swallowed the shape of Rowan’s glans, the act of being penetrated in her bottom got her stomach so tight that her pussy crushed walls against Grady’s cock. And when she crushed on Grady’s cock, his cock flexed inside her. The pleasure was unexpected, swelling up like hot waves on summer asphalt, getting her mouth to hang open. A line of drool spilled her lip and Grady thumbed it, kissed her forehead. Rowan sunk inches inside her, and she cried out. There was pain but she would not stop this because under that bright feeling of overload on her sex tissues she knew if they went slow she could take them and there was a dark orb swirling in her guts—a hungry magical shape that wanted to do terrible things with both of these hot and sexy guys . . .

“Okay,” she gasped, “okay, Rowan, baby, a little more . . .” Her voice was thin and high and breathy. Her heart hammered in her chest.

GRADY

As Rowan sunk his cock up Paisley's ass he could feel his friend's cock's belly gliding across his own—a wild and erotic charge going off in his head—but it was silenced watching Paisley's beautiful face transformed by the dirty thing they were doing to her. Her mouth went to an O, then wriggled through all the vowel sounds, then she chuffed air in a way that reminded him of being in the gym before lifting a heavy weight. Her breath breezed his cheek, and he kissed her ear. And then before they even got to move around, Paisley stiffened, dug her nails in his arms, and through a pinched-tight voice squeaked, “Oh god, oh god, oh god, right there, oh right there, don't move, oh right there . . .”

And both he and Rowan stayed still, holding her, his cock flexing over and over, Rowan's doing the same, both their dicks filling up Paisley and stretching her out. She tensed, hitched breath, then began seizing and trembling, laughing and gulping back the laugh. Shaking then, twitching, trying to enjoy the pleasure of having two dicks in her but afraid of thrashing around and getting hurt. “Ah, ah,” she chanted, still going through an insane orgasm that sounded like it'd short-circuited the sweet girl's brain. He laughed too, kissed the crown of her head and hugged her.

She babbled and laughed now, “Oh god, that's so . . . so wild, oh, don't stop, Rowan, baby, a little more,” and Rowan asking her if she just came, and Paisley chuckling, saying, “Came so . . . so huh-hard . . .” His eyes met Rowan's, and they both suppressed laughter.

What they were doing was crazy. It was crazy, but they would figure it out. There was a feeling of togetherness and though he'd feared coming to Malta, now he knew it was the best decision of his life. He hated to see

Rowan and Paisley together sometimes, but loved them both dearly. A threesome would work. It might be weird, but they would make it work.

He cupped his Paisley's face, looked into her foggy, sex-hazed eyes. "I think this relationship might work," he said, and Rowan chuckled.

She shook her head no, and he frowned. "No?"

"No," she said, clearing hair from her face. Then over her shoulder to Rowan: "We're not going to Greece next with Grady—we've already been there. We're not going to Spain—Grady's already been there . . ."

His heart flooded away the momentary fear. He said, "We'll make new plans."

Rowan sucked his lower lip, began stroking into Paisley again, hands on her waist, getting her moaning. "North Africa? . . ."

Paisley gasped and groaned, made a happy chuckle, her sex squeezing on him again. She kissed his mouth, bit his lower lip. She whispered, "We'll make our own way together. The three of us . . ."

He humped his cock a little, testing Paisley's readiness. She was ready.

Both he and Rowan began stroking in and out of her, trying to stay syncopated, and Paisley made her sweet sex noises again, letting them know it was all good. She was sandwiched between them, Rowan was watching him, the two of them communicating with their eyes, working as a team. Their goal: make this amazing girl come so hard she screams.

It was only ten in the morning. Ten in the morning on their first day together as a throuple. He'd be with Paisley today. His best friend today. Both of them. Three of them. Tomorrow, too. And the next day after that. He couldn't be happier.

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